

THE

THIMBLE HILL
WORD SEARCH MYSTERIES

60 cozy word searches, 10 gentle mysteries,
and a clue hidden in every grid

BLAKE LA PIERRE

The Thimble Hill Word Search Mysteries
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This is a work of fiction. Thimble Hill and everyone in it are made up,
and any resemblance to real people or places is coincidence.

Every grid was checked by computer: each listed word appears exactly once,
and the leftover letters spell the hidden clue exactly.

No one is ever hurt in Thimble Hill. Things go missing, and there is always a kind reason.

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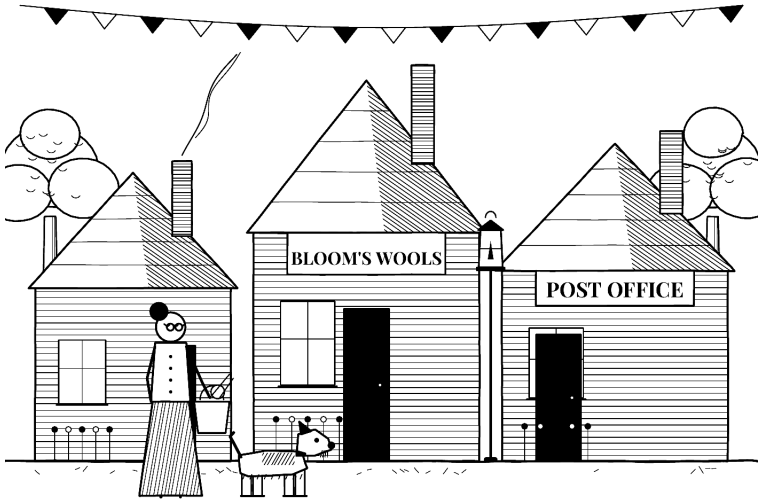
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WELCOME TO THIMBLE HILL



Thimble Hill is a small village with one high street, one post office, a library, a bandstand and a great many cakes. Nothing terrible ever happens here. But things do go missing: a prize ribbon, a pie, a garden gnome, a song.

When they do, people walk to the wool shop on the high street and knock on the door of **Hattie Bloom**. Hattie has knitted for sixty years and notices everything. She is helped, and sometimes hindered, by **Pickle**, a scruffy little terrier with a nose for trouble.

In this book you are Hattie's partner. Every case has six word searches, and every word search hides one clue. Find the clues, cross off the suspects, and tell Hattie who did it. There is always a kind reason in the end.

How to Solve a Word Search Mystery

1. Read the case. Each case opens with what went missing and the four suspects. Every suspect has something about them worth remembering.

2. Find every word. Each grid hides the words in its list. Tick the little box as you find each one and draw a loop round it in the grid. Letters can be shared where two words cross.

3. Read the leftover letters. When every word is found, some letters are left over. Read them in order, left to right along each row, starting with the top row. They spell out a clue. Write it in the boxes under the grid. The boxes show how many letters are in each word.

4. Solve the case. After six grids you will have six clues. Turn to the Case Notes page, cross off the suspects the clues rule out, and write down who did it, and why you think so.

5. Check your answer. The solved grids start on page 97 and Hattie explains every case from page 113.

Three levels

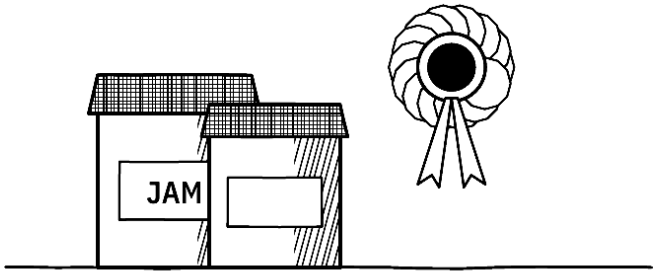
●○○	Gentle	Words run left to right, top to bottom, or diagonally down to the right. Nothing is backwards.
●●○	Curious	Words run left to right, top to bottom, diagonally down to the right, or diagonally up to the right. Nothing is backwards.
●●●	Sharp-Eyed	Words can run in all eight directions, including backwards and diagonally both ways.

Cases 1 to 3 are Gentle, cases 4 to 7 are Curious, and cases 8 to 10 are Sharp-Eyed. The grids are all 12 by 12 squares. A sharp pencil and a soft eraser are the only tools you need.

CASE ONE

THE BLUE RIBBON JAM

The Summer Fair



The Thimble Hill Summer Fair was in full swing. Bunting snapped in the breeze, the brass band puffed away on the bandstand, and the jam judges had just pinned a blue ribbon to the winning jar. Then they went off for a cup of tea. When they came back, the ribbon was gone. Hattie Bloom, who runs the wool shop on the high street, put down her toffee apple, called her terrier Pickle to heel, and went to have a look.

LEVEL: GENTLE ●○○

The Suspects

- [ ] **Della Pruitt** came second in the jam contest last year and the year before. She had been bottling strawberry jam all morning and her fingers were still pink.
- [ ] **Rupert Vane** runs the fair. He wears a bow tie, carries a clipboard everywhere, and was due to read out the winners on the bandstand stage.
- [ ] **Lottie Green** is ten years old and spent the whole day zooming between the stalls on roller skates, delivering lemonade.
- [ ] **Amos Hale** keeps bees on the edge of the village. He never takes off his thick canvas gloves when his honey stall is open.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

Puzzle 1

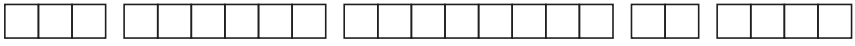
Clue 1 of 6 ●○○

The judges' table stood under a striped awning. Hattie asked when the ribbon was last seen, and the judges all agreed on one thing.

D	R	U	M	M	E	R	T	H	E	R	M
J	B	B	A	S	U	N	S	H	I	N	E
U	A	U	R	I	T	O	M	B	O	L	A
D	N	T	M	P	A	R	A	S	O	L	D
G	D	T	A	B	K	I	T	E	B	W	O
E	S	E	L	O	B	C	O	N	V	I	W
S	T	R	A	W	B	E	R	R	Y	N	A
N	A	C	D	T	I	C	S	H	E	N	D
A	N	U	E	I	T	R	U	M	P	E	T
T	D	P	R	E	S	E	R	V	E	R	N
C	L	I	P	B	O	A	R	D	O	O	N
R	A	F	F	L	E	M	S	P	O	O	N

- ☐ BANDSTAND
- ☐ BOWTIE
- ☐ BUTTERCUP
- ☐ CLIPBOARD
- ☐ DRUMMER
- ☐ ICECREAM
- ☐ JUDGES
- ☐ KITE
- ☐ MARMALADE
- ☐ MEADOW
- ☐ PARASOL
- ☐ PRESERVE
- ☐ RAFFLE
- ☐ SPOON
- ☐ STRAWBERRY
- ☐ SUNSHINE
- ☐ TOMBOLA
- ☐ TRUMPET
- ☐ WINNER

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 2

Clue 2 of 6 ●○○

On the white tablecloth, right where the ribbon had been, Hattie spotted a smudge. She bent down with her reading glasses.

H	O	N	E	Y	T	W	H	E	T	R	C
H	T	G	I	N	G	H	A	M	I	A	R
B	R	S	U	M	M	E	R	F	E	F	E
U	A	P	R	I	C	O	T	F	F	F	A
N	C	L	W	E	L	L	I	E	S	L	M
T	T	W	L	B	E	E	H	I	V	E	E
I	O	O	R	O	M	R	I	B	B	O	N
N	R	C	A	R	O	U	S	E	L	E	N
G	A	P	R	O	N	N	O	J	A	R	S
G	L	S	T	R	A	W	B	E	R	R	Y
O	P	O	N	Y	D	S	C	O	N	E	S
R	A	S	P	B	E	R	R	Y	V	E	S

- ☐ APRICOT
- ☐ APRON
- ☐ BALLOON
- ☐ BEEHIVE
- ☐ BUNTING
- ☐ CAROUSEL
- ☐ CREAM
- ☐ GINGHAM
- ☐ HONEY
- ☐ JARS
- ☐ LEMONADE
- ☐ PONY
- ☐ RAFFLE
- ☐ RASPBERRY
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ SCONES
- ☐ STRAWBERRY
- ☐ SUMMER
- ☐ TRACTOR
- ☐ WAFFLE
- ☐ WELLIES

The leftover letters spell

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Puzzle 3

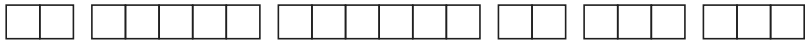
Clue 3 of 6 ●○○

Behind the table the grass was soft and muddy from last night's rain. Pickle sniffed along the ground.

B	L	A	N	K	E	T	N	M	O	W	F
D	A	I	S	Y	M	R	J	A	R	S	L
H	T	P	K	E	A	O	C	R	E	T	A
L	R	R	A	B	R	S	L	M	R	R	G
I	A	E	T	U	Q	E	I	A	A	A	S
G	C	S	E	T	U	T	P	L	S	W	G
I	T	E	S	T	E	T	B	A	P	B	A
N	O	R	C	E	E	E	O	D	B	E	R
G	R	V	T	R	R	A	A	E	E	R	L
H	C	E	K	C	E	S	R	I	R	R	A
A	N	T	H	U	E	A	D	M	R	Y	N
M	T	E	A	P	O	T	M	U	Y	D	D

- ☐ BLANKET
- ☐ BUTTERCUP
- ☐ CLIPBOARD
- ☐ DAISY
- ☐ FLAGS
- ☐ GARLAND
- ☐ GINGHAM
- ☐ ICECREAM
- ☐ JARS
- ☐ MARMALADE
- ☐ MARQUEE
- ☐ PRESERVE
- ☐ RASPBERRY
- ☐ ROSETTE
- ☐ SKATES
- ☐ STRAWBERRY
- ☐ TEAPOT
- ☐ TRACTOR

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 4

Clue 4 of 6 ●○○

Hattie walked over to the bandstand, where the band was packing up their music stands, and asked who had been up there.

R	M	C	L	I	P	B	O	A	R	D	U
B	A	N	D	S	T	A	N	D	P	E	R
P	R	I	Z	E	R	P	I	C	N	I	C
G	M	T	W	A	U	R	B	S	O	R	P
L	A	B	E	L	M	I	U	T	N	A	R
S	L	R	O	T	P	C	T	O	B	S	E
A	A	A	L	O	E	O	T	M	U	P	S
G	D	S	E	A	T	T	E	B	N	B	E
A	E	S	T	N	N	H	R	O	T	E	R
M	E	A	D	O	W	D	C	L	I	R	V
B	A	L	L	O	O	N	U	A	N	R	E
O	T	O	F	F	E	E	P	O	G	Y	N

- ☐ APRICOT
- ☐ BALLOON
- ☐ BANDSTAND
- ☐ BOOTH
- ☐ BRASS
- ☐ BUNTING
- ☐ BUTTERCUP
- ☐ CLIPBOARD
- ☐ GARLAND
- ☐ LABEL
- ☐ MARMALADE
- ☐ MEADOW
- ☐ PICNIC
- ☐ PRESERVE
- ☐ PRIZE
- ☐ RASPBERRY
- ☐ TOFFEE
- ☐ TOMBOLA
- ☐ TRUMPET

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 5

Clue 5 of 6 ●○○

Back at the table, Hattie looked at the smudge again. It was a thumbprint, and it was not an ordinary color.

T	H	R	A	S	P	B	E	R	R	Y	E
P	L	E	M	O	N	A	D	E	R	I	N
C	R	A	T	C	A	W	N	I	N	G	S
A	O	G	P	I	U	T	E	A	P	O	T
R	S	A	T	R	O	P	H	Y	S	W	R
O	E	R	P	I	O	U	C	N	K	I	A
U	T	L	F	A	S	N	N	A	S	N	W
S	T	A	L	L	T	C	K	D	K	N	B
E	E	N	A	S	U	H	O	I	A	E	E
L	W	D	G	E	B	E	T	N	T	R	R
J	A	R	S	W	A	F	F	L	E	E	R
B	A	N	D	S	T	A	N	D	S	S	Y

- ☐ APRON
- ☐ AWNING
- ☐ BANDSTAND
- ☐ CAROUSEL
- ☐ CUPCAKE
- ☐ FLAGS
- ☐ GARLAND
- ☐ JARS
- ☐ KITE
- ☐ LEMONADE
- ☐ PUNCH
- ☐ RASPBERRY
- ☐ ROSETTE
- ☐ SCONES
- ☐ SKATES
- ☐ STALL
- ☐ STRAWBERRY
- ☐ TEAPOT
- ☐ TROPHY
- ☐ TUBA
- ☐ WAFFLE
- ☐ WINNER

The leftover letters spell

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Puzzle 6

Clue 6 of 6 ●○○

Pickle gave the tablecloth one long, happy sniff and wagged his tail. Hattie sniffed too.

I	T	C	B	A	L	L	O	O	N	S	T
M	K	U	E	T	P	R	I	Z	E	S	O
S	I	P	L	H	R	L	S	O	H	U	M
T	T	C	F	P	A	O	S	T	O	N	B
A	E	A	E	I	S	Y	P	R	N	S	O
L	A	K	A	C	D	U	B	H	E	H	L
L	W	E	B	N	R	J	M	A	Y	I	A
B	N	T	O	I	U	E	U	M	L	N	B
O	I	U	W	C	M	W	A	D	E	E	R
O	N	B	T	B	M	E	R	M	G	R	A
T	G	A	I	B	E	E	H	I	V	E	S
H	R	Y	E	T	R	A	C	T	O	R	S

- ☐ AWNING
- ☐ BALLOON
- ☐ BEEHIVE
- ☐ BOOTH
- ☐ BOWTIE
- ☐ BRASS
- ☐ CUPCAKE
- ☐ DRUMMER
- ☐ HAYBALE
- ☐ HONEY
- ☐ ICECREAM
- ☐ JUDGES
- ☐ KITE
- ☐ PICNIC
- ☐ PRIZE
- ☐ STALL
- ☐ SUMMER
- ☐ SUNSHINE
- ☐ TOMBOLA
- ☐ TRACTOR
- ☐ TROPHY
- ☐ TUBA

The leftover letters spell

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Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 1 to 6.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Della Pruitt _____
- ☐ Rupert Vane _____
- ☐ Lottie Green _____
- ☐ Amos Hale _____

Who Did It, and Why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

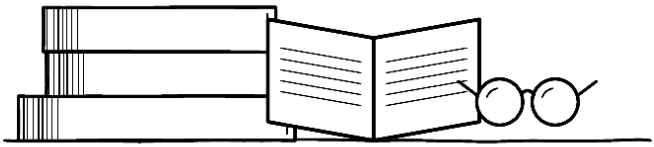
_____

Check your answer with Hattie on page 113.

Case Two

The Missing First Edition

Thimble Hill Library



Once a year the library brings out its treasure: a signed first edition of The Hedgerow Year, a book of garden poems written by a woman who grew up on Thimble Hill. It sits in a glass case in the reading room for one afternoon only. This year, at the end of story hour, the case was open and the book was gone. In its place was a folded note. The head librarian ran straight to the wool shop to fetch Hattie Bloom.

Level: Gentle ●○○

The Suspects

- [ ] **Professor Edmund Shaw** is a visiting scholar who studies country poets. He writes all his notes in green ink with an old fountain pen.

- [ ] **Nell Archer** is the librarian's assistant. She looks after the key to the glass case and stamps the books at the front desk.

- [ ] **Basil Thorn** collects rare books. He fell off his bicycle last week and his right arm is in a sling.

- [ ] **Mira Patel** teaches the village school. She brought her whole class in for story hour in the children's corner.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

PUZZLE 7

CLUE 1 OF 6 ●○○

Hattie began with the clock. The librarian said the book was there at two and gone by three, which was exactly the time of one event.

B	C	I	W	H	I	S	P	E	R	T	W
O	A	A	R	N	S	I	A	T	A	K	D
O	T	E	E	O	H	G	R	N	I	S	I
K	A	L	A	T	E	N	C	N	L	O	C
M	L	A	D	E	D	A	H	E	I	N	T
A	O	D	I	B	G	T	M	N	B	N	I
R	G	D	N	O	E	U	E	V	R	E	O
K	S	E	G	O	R	R	N	E	A	T	N
T	O	R	R	K	O	E	T	L	R	C	A
F	A	B	L	E	W	Y	H	O	I	A	R
B	O	R	R	O	W	M	A	P	A	R	Y
V	O	L	U	M	E	O	U	E	N	D	R

- ☐ BOOKMARK
- ☐ BORROW
- ☐ CARD
- ☐ CATALOG
- ☐ DICTIONARY
- ☐ ENVELOPE
- ☐ FABLE
- ☐ HEDGEROW
- ☐ LADDER
- ☐ LIBRARIAN
- ☐ MAP
- ☐ NOTEBOOK
- ☐ PARCHMENT
- ☐ READING
- ☐ SIGNATURE
- ☐ SONNET
- ☐ VOLUME
- ☐ WHISPER

THE LEFTOVER LETTERS SPELL

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Puzzle 8

Clue 2 of 6 ●○○

Hattie peeked into the children's corner, where twenty small readers were sitting on cushions. They all told her the same thing.

M	D	I	S	P	B	E	S	C	P	L	A
F	R	I	T	O	I	D	R	A	S	I	E
O	I	L	C	E	N	I	E	B	I	B	I
U	B	R	Q	T	D	T	A	I	G	R	N
N	B	P	U	R	I	I	D	N	N	A	K
T	O	R	I	Y	N	O	I	E	A	R	W
A	N	E	L	E	G	N	N	T	T	I	E
I	A	F	L	A	M	P	G	A	U	A	L
N	D	A	U	T	H	O	R	P	R	N	L
J	A	C	K	E	T	A	L	L	E	Y	H
O	H	E	D	G	E	R	O	W	U	N	R
S	C	H	O	L	A	R	E	T	U	R	N

- ☐ AUTHOR
- ☐ BINDING
- ☐ CABINET
- ☐ DICTIONARY
- ☐ EDITION
- ☐ FOUNTAIN
- ☐ HEDGEROW
- ☐ INKWELL
- ☐ JACKET
- ☐ LAMP
- ☐ LIBRARIAN
- ☐ PEN
- ☐ POETRY
- ☐ PREFACE
- ☐ QUILL
- ☐ READING
- ☐ RETURN
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ SCHOLAR
- ☐ SIGNATURE

The leftover letters spell

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Puzzle 9

Clue 3 of 6 ●○○

Next Hattie went to the front desk, where a long line of people had been waiting to borrow books.

P	L	I	B	R	A	R	I	A	N	P	N
A	A	E	L	D	C	A	T	A	L	O	G
R	M	S	P	I	N	E	L	S	C	E	W
C	P	E	N	C	I	L	G	I	H	M	H
H	S	D	O	T	N	W	L	G	A	A	I
M	H	I	T	I	K	C	O	N	P	C	S
E	E	T	E	O	W	U	B	A	T	O	P
N	L	I	B	N	E	S	E	T	E	V	E
T	V	O	O	A	L	H	S	U	R	E	R
A	E	N	O	R	L	I	B	R	A	R	Y
T	S	T	K	Y	N	O	V	E	L	S	H
E	D	E	S	W	I	N	D	O	W	E	K

- ☐ CATALOG
- ☐ CHAPTER
- ☐ COVER
- ☐ CUSHION
- ☐ DICTIONARY
- ☐ EDITION
- ☐ GLOBE
- ☐ INKWELL
- ☐ LAMP
- ☐ LIBRARIAN
- ☐ LIBRARY
- ☐ NOTEBOOK
- ☐ NOVEL
- ☐ PARCHMENT
- ☐ PENCIL
- ☐ POEM
- ☐ SHELVES
- ☐ SIGNATURE
- ☐ SPINE
- ☐ VERSE
- ☐ WHISPER
- ☐ WINDOW

The leftover letters spell

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Puzzle 10

Clue 4 of 6 ●○○

Hattie looked closely at the glass case. Nothing was broken or scratched, and the folded note was still lying on the velvet.

A	P	N	L	S	H	E	L	V	E	S	O
C	R	A	S	I	G	N	A	T	U	R	E
P	A	E	P	T	B	E	T	W	S	A	N
L	E	T	T	E	R	R	L	S	T	S	O
L	T	N	A	U	R	L	A	E	O	C	T
A	R	I	C	L	R	E	S	R	R	H	E
D	I	C	T	I	O	N	A	R	Y	O	B
D	B	F	T	L	L	G	I	D	N	L	O
E	B	E	N	V	E	L	O	P	E	A	O
R	O	S	C	A	B	I	N	E	T	R	K
I	N	D	P	A	R	C	H	M	E	N	T
I	N	D	E	X	V	E	L	V	E	T	E

- ☐ ATLAS
- ☐ CABINET
- ☐ CATALOG
- ☐ DICTIONARY
- ☐ ENVELOPE
- ☐ INDEX
- ☐ LADDER
- ☐ LETTER
- ☐ LIBRARY
- ☐ NOTEBOOK
- ☐ PAPER
- ☐ PARCHMENT
- ☐ PENCIL
- ☐ READER
- ☐ RETURN
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ SCHOLAR
- ☐ SHELVES
- ☐ SIGNATURE
- ☐ STORY
- ☐ TITLE
- ☐ VELVET

The leftover letters spell

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Puzzle 11

Clue 5 of 6 ●○○

She unfolded the note. It said: Sorry, I will bring it back by closing time. The writing was small and very neat.

I	T	P	A	R	C	H	M	E	N	T	L
I	S	N	O	G	L	A	S	S	E	A	E
T	C	L	Y	E	H	J	A	C	K	E	T
P	A	G	E	S	M	A	N	H	D	W	T
L	B	R	B	O	O	K	M	A	R	K	E
I	I	V	O	L	U	M	E	P	E	N	R
B	N	I	T	F	O	U	N	T	A	I	N
R	E	N	V	E	L	O	P	E	D	N	S
A	T	S	C	H	O	L	A	R	E	D	T
R	H	E	D	G	E	R	O	W	R	E	A
Y	T	E	N	W	I	N	D	O	W	X	M
V	E	L	V	E	T	A	T	L	A	S	P

- ☐ ATLAS
- ☐ BOOKMARK
- ☐ CABINET
- ☐ CHAPTER
- ☐ ENVELOPE
- ☐ FOUNTAIN
- ☐ GLASS
- ☐ HEDGEROW
- ☐ INDEX
- ☐ JACKET
- ☐ LETTER
- ☐ LIBRARY
- ☐ PAGES
- ☐ PARCHMENT
- ☐ PEN
- ☐ POEM
- ☐ READER
- ☐ SCHOLAR
- ☐ STAMP
- ☐ VELVET
- ☐ VOLUME
- ☐ WINDOW

The leftover letters spell

☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 12

Clue 6 of 6 ●○○

Hattie held the note up to the window and smiled at the color of the ink.

P	A	S	T	A	M	P	P	T	H	L	V
O	T	S	E	I	F	N	E	K	B	I	O
E	L	A	O	Q	O	Q	N	I	O	B	L
T	A	U	S	N	U	U	C	F	R	R	U
R	S	T	H	C	N	I	I	A	R	A	M
Y	R	H	E	O	T	E	L	B	O	R	E
P	H	O	L	V	A	T	T	L	W	I	D
A	Y	R	V	E	I	P	O	E	M	A	E
P	M	S	E	R	N	O	V	E	L	N	S
E	E	G	S	N	O	T	E	B	O	O	K
R	P	R	E	F	A	C	E	R	E	E	N
S	P	I	N	E	C	U	S	H	I	O	N

- ☐ ATLAS
- ☐ AUTHOR
- ☐ BORROW
- ☐ COVER
- ☐ CUSHION
- ☐ DESK
- ☐ FABLE
- ☐ FOUNTAIN
- ☐ LIBRARIAN
- ☐ NOTEBOOK
- ☐ NOVEL
- ☐ PAPER
- ☐ PENCIL
- ☐ POEM
- ☐ POETRY
- ☐ PREFACE
- ☐ QUIET
- ☐ QUILL
- ☐ RHYME
- ☐ SHELVES
- ☐ SONNET
- ☐ SPINE
- ☐ STAMP
- ☐ VOLUME

The leftover letters spell

Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 7 to 12.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Professor Edmund Shaw _____
- ☐ Nell Archer _____
- ☐ Basil Thorn _____
- ☐ Mira Patel _____

Who Did It, and Why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

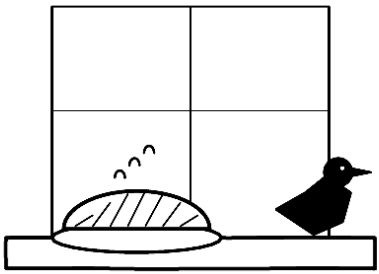
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Check your answer with Hattie on page 113.

CASE THREE

THE CHERRY PIE ON THE SILL

Larkspur Cottage



Bea Lark had baked her famous cherry pie for the Thimble Hill Bake-Off and set it on the kitchen windowsill to cool. The sill is outside the window and high above the garden path. At half past ten Bea went to fetch it, and the pie was gone, dish and all. The bake-off judging was at noon. Bea telephoned Hattie Bloom, who arrived with Pickle and a notebook.

LEVEL: GENTLE ●○○

The Suspects

- [ ] **Tom Fenn** is the village postman. He is very tall and was doing his morning round with his big canvas mailbag.
- [ ] **Rosa Lind** lives next door and grows roses. She said she had been out all morning.
- [ ] **Ollie Bramble** is eight years old and loves pie more than anything, but he is small for his age.
- [ ] **Gregor Bunn** runs the bakery and is Bea's great rival in the bake-off. He always has flour on his apron.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

Puzzle 13

Clue 1 of 6 ●○○

Bea said the pie was on the sill at ten. Hattie wrote it down and looked up at the window.

R	T	R	O	L	L	I	N	G	H	S	B
O	C	E	P	A	E	C	R	O	W	P	A
S	I	K	E	T	T	L	E	O	I	O	K
E	N	I	F	T	T	G	S	R	N	O	E
S	N	E	L	I	E	A	U	C	D	N	R
P	A	M	O	C	R	R	G	H	O	C	Y
R	M	T	U	E	W	D	A	A	W	R	P
I	O	E	R	F	A	E	R	R	S	U	A
N	N	A	S	T	F	N	H	D	I	M	T
K	E	P	I	C	N	I	C	R	L	B	H
L	E	O	A	T	V	A	N	I	L	L	A
E	T	T	P	A	S	T	R	Y	E	E	N

- ☐ BAKERY
- ☐ CINNAMON
- ☐ CROW
- ☐ CRUMBLE
- ☐ FLOUR
- ☐ GARDEN
- ☐ KETTLE
- ☐ LATTICE
- ☐ LETTER
- ☐ MUFFIN
- ☐ ORCHARD
- ☐ PASTRY
- ☐ PATH
- ☐ PICNIC
- ☐ ROLLING
- ☐ ROSES
- ☐ SPOON
- ☐ SPRINKLE
- ☐ SUGAR
- ☐ TEAPOT
- ☐ VANILLA
- ☐ WINDOWSILL

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 14

Clue 2 of 6 ●○○

Hattie stood on tiptoe and could only just touch the sill herself. She made a note.

J D T G H E W G A T E B
S U I S A S I A P I N R
I L D S P R N W P L L E
I S I G H O D V H R E A
P A R C E L O E R I O D
Y F H P E S W N N I S N
C E P O C U S T A R D K
R A I S S K I T C H E N
U T C T T G L H E D G E
S H N M A I L B A G H U
T E I A M C R U M B L E
P R C N P B L O S S O M

- ☐ APRON
- ☐ BLOSSOM
- ☐ BREAD
- ☐ CRUMBLE
- ☐ CRUST
- ☐ CUSTARD
- ☐ DISH
- ☐ FEATHER
- ☐ GARDEN
- ☐ GATE
- ☐ HEDGE
- ☐ JUDGES
- ☐ KITCHEN
- ☐ MAILBAG
- ☐ PARCEL
- ☐ PICNIC
- ☐ PIN
- ☐ POSTMAN
- ☐ SLICE
- ☐ SPOON
- ☐ STAMP
- ☐ WHISK
- ☐ WINDOWSILL

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐

Puzzle 15

Clue 3 of 6 ●○○

Next door, Hattie found Rosa's husband trimming the hedge. He told her where Rosa had been.

R	W	S	T	O	B	S	A	P	W	P	A
S	I	L	R	C	I	N	N	A	M	O	N
B	N	I	A	B	S	M	C	S	A	S	A
L	D	C	Y	U	C	A	R	T	P	T	T
O	O	E	O	T	U	I	U	R	R	M	T
S	W	H	D	T	I	L	S	Y	O	A	F
S	S	N	O	E	T	B	T	E	N	N	E
O	I	D	U	R	P	A	R	C	E	L	A
M	L	E	G	T	D	G	G	N	C	E	T
P	L	T	H	I	M	I	X	E	R	M	H
S	I	P	R	I	Z	E	S	T	O	O	E
V	A	N	I	L	L	A	G	H	W	N	R

- ☐ APRON
- ☐ BISCUIT
- ☐ BLOSSOM
- ☐ BUTTER
- ☐ CINNAMON
- ☐ COTTAGE
- ☐ CROW
- ☐ CRUST
- ☐ DISH
- ☐ DOUGH
- ☐ FEATHER
- ☐ LEMON
- ☐ MAILBAG
- ☐ MIXER
- ☐ NUTMEG
- ☐ PARCEL
- ☐ PASTRY
- ☐ PIN
- ☐ POSTMAN
- ☐ PRIZE
- ☐ SLICE
- ☐ TRAY
- ☐ VANILLA
- ☐ WINDOWSILL

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 16

Clue 4 of 6 ●○○

Hattie walked down to the bakery. The shop was full of customers, and the ovens were roaring.

S C O N E B U T T E R L
W G O R C H A R D G R E
I E A G K I T C H E N T
N E S T F L O U R O U T
D R C N E K E P L A T E
O V H M I X E R E R M R
W L E E C O T T A G E B
S P R I N K L E T F G R
I C R U M B L E A L T E
L H Y J U D G E S P E A
L V A N I L L A I S O D
S H O P L A T T I C E T

- ☐ BREAD
- ☐ BUTTER
- ☐ CHERRY
- ☐ COTTAGE
- ☐ CRUMBLE
- ☐ FLOUR
- ☐ GATE
- ☐ JUDGES
- ☐ KETTLE
- ☐ KITCHEN
- ☐ LATTICE
- ☐ LETTER
- ☐ MIXER
- ☐ NEST
- ☐ NUTMEG
- ☐ ORCHARD
- ☐ PLATE
- ☐ SCONE
- ☐ SPRINKLE
- ☐ TEAPOT
- ☐ VANILLA
- ☐ WINDOWSILL

The leftover letters spell

Puzzle 17

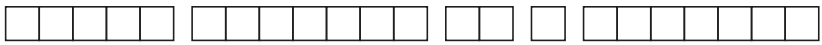
Clue 5 of 6 ●○○

Back at the cottage, Pickle found a few dark red drops on the path, leading toward the front gate.

J	U	R	O	S	E	S	B	R	E	A	D
K	F	L	O	U	R	O	L	L	I	N	G
I	O	I	S	C	I	N	N	A	M	O	N
T	C	V	N	P	G	A	R	D	E	N	E
C	C	H	E	R	R	Y	S	U	G	A	R
H	U	D	S	N	R	I	D	I	S	H	F
E	I	S	T	A	M	P	N	O	P	E	E
N	P	E	T	A	R	T	R	K	U	D	A
O	R	C	H	A	R	D	D	I	L	G	T
O	P	A	S	T	R	Y	N	A	Z	E	H
B	U	T	T	E	R	D	M	A	I	E	E
L	L	A	T	T	I	C	E	B	A	G	R

- ☐ BREAD
- ☐ BUTTER
- ☐ CHERRY
- ☐ CINNAMON
- ☐ CUSTARD
- ☐ DISH
- ☐ DOUGH
- ☐ FEATHER
- ☐ FLOUR
- ☐ GARDEN
- ☐ HEDGE
- ☐ KITCHEN
- ☐ LATTICE
- ☐ NEST
- ☐ ORCHARD
- ☐ OVEN
- ☐ PASTRY
- ☐ PRIZE
- ☐ ROLLING
- ☐ ROSES
- ☐ SPRINKLE
- ☐ STAMP
- ☐ SUGAR
- ☐ TART

The leftover letters spell



PUZZLE 18

CLUE 6 OF 6 ●○○

Hattie looked at the sill again and found three black feathers and a lot of little scratch marks.

B	L	O	S	S	O	M	S	L	I	C	E
R	O	S	E	S	P	R	I	N	K	L	E
A	V	A	N	I	L	L	A	B	B	I	R
G	C	W	T	R	A	Y	A	R	O	O	O
C	W	H	K	C	R	U	S	T	W	W	L
A	U	I	E	A	J	U	D	G	E	S	L
P	O	S	T	M	A	N	S	O	N	C	I
R	T	K	T	C	I	N	N	A	M	O	N
O	H	E	L	A	M	U	F	F	I	N	G
N	S	I	E	L	R	N	U	T	M	E	G
T	E	A	P	O	T	D	P	R	I	Z	E
L	E	M	O	N	B	A	K	E	R	Y	L

- ☐ APRON
- ☐ BAKERY
- ☐ BLOSSOM
- ☐ BOWL
- ☐ CINNAMON
- ☐ CRUST
- ☐ CUSTARD
- ☐ JUDGES
- ☐ KETTLE
- ☐ LEMON
- ☐ MUFFIN
- ☐ NUTMEG
- ☐ PLATE
- ☐ POSTMAN
- ☐ PRIZE
- ☐ ROLLING
- ☐ ROSES
- ☐ SCONE
- ☐ SLICE
- ☐ SPRINKLE
- ☐ TEAPOT
- ☐ TRAY
- ☐ VANILLA
- ☐ WHISK

THE LEFTOVER LETTERS SPELL

☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 13 to 18.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Tom Fenn _____
- ☐ Rosa Lind _____
- ☐ Ollie Bramble _____
- ☐ Gregor Bunn _____

Who Did It, and Why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

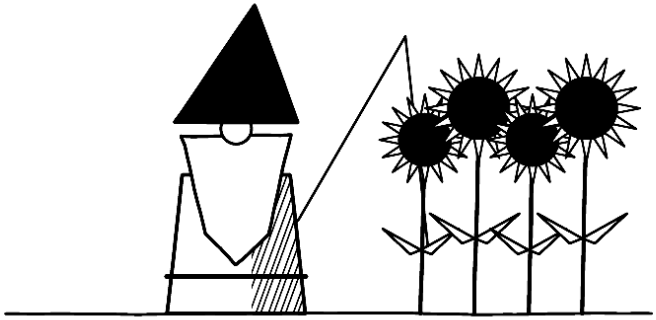
_____

Check your answer with Hattie on page 113.

CASE FOUR

THE GNOME WHO WALKED AWAY

Mossbank Garden



Wendell Moss has the tidiest garden on Thimble Hill, and in the middle of it stands Sir Pumpernickel, a garden gnome with a red hat and a fishing rod. The Best Garden judge was due at three. At a quarter past two, Wendell went out to give Sir Pumpernickel a polish, and found only a round mark in the soil where he used to stand. Hattie Bloom was there in five minutes.

LEVEL: CURIOUS ●●○

The Suspects

- [ ] **Clara Bell** lives across the lane and says gnomes are silly. She wears smart shoes with tall, thin heels.
- [ ] **Jasper Quill** is the Best Garden judge. He drives a little green car and is never early for anything.
- [ ] **Hugo Penn** is a teenager who delivers the newspapers on his bicycle.
- [ ] **Mabel Rook** paints pictures of village gardens. There is usually a dab of blue paint somewhere on her.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

Puzzle 19

Clue 1 of 6 ●●○

Wendell said he last saw Sir Pumpernickel at lunch, and he was gone at a quarter past two.

P	P	A	I	N	T	B	R	U	S	H	T
R	B	U	T	T	E	R	F	L	Y	L	H
I	E	L	A	V	E	N	D	E	R	A	G
Z	N	H	T	R	E	L	L	I	S	T	O
E	M	E	H	O	L	L	Y	H	O	C	K
G	R	E	E	N	H	O	U	S	E	H	W
F	L	O	W	E	R	B	E	D	T	A	S
G	W	H	E	E	L	B	A	R	R	O	W
R	A	K	E	F	O	X	G	L	O	V	E
O	P	A	L	E	T	T	E	N	W	D	E
M	U	S	H	R	O	O	M	B	E	Y	T
T	O	A	D	S	T	O	O	L	L	W	O

- ☐ BUTTERFLY
- ☐ FLOWERBED
- ☐ FOXGLOVE
- ☐ GREENHOUSE
- ☐ HAT
- ☐ HOLLYHOCK
- ☐ LATCH
- ☐ LAVENDER
- ☐ MUSHROOM
- ☐ PAINTBRUSH
- ☐ PALETTE
- ☐ PRIZE
- ☐ RAKE
- ☐ ROD
- ☐ TOADSTOOL
- ☐ TRELLIS
- ☐ TROWEL
- ☐ WHEELBARROW

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐

Puzzle 20

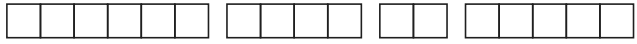
Clue 2 of 6 ●●○

Hattie asked about the judge. Wendell checked his watch and pointed at the little green car pulling up.

P	A	T	H	W	A	Y	R	O	B	I	N
S	B	U	T	T	E	R	F	L	Y	J	F
U	F	L	O	W	E	R	B	E	D	K	O
N	L	A	D	Y	B	I	R	D	C	S	U
D	A	F	F	O	D	I	L	O	A	P	N
I	F	L	U	P	I	N	H	S	P	A	T
A	I	E	R	C	A	Y	M	E	C	D	A
L	S	U	N	F	L	O	W	E	R	E	I
W	H	E	E	L	B	A	R	R	O	W	N
A	I	T	O	W	A	T	E	R	I	N	G
T	N	H	S	E	E	D	L	I	N	G	H
R	G	R	O	S	E	M	A	R	Y	E	E

- ☐ BUTTERFLY
- ☐ CAN
- ☐ DAFFODIL
- ☐ FISHING
- ☐ FLOWERBED
- ☐ FOUNTAIN
- ☐ HOLLYHOCK
- ☐ LADYBIRD
- ☐ LUPIN
- ☐ PATHWAY
- ☐ ROBIN
- ☐ ROSEMARY
- ☐ SEEDLING
- ☐ SPADE
- ☐ SUNDIAL
- ☐ SUNFLOWER
- ☐ WATERING
- ☐ WHEELBARROW

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 21

Clue 3 of 6 ●●○

Hattie looked at the garden gate and found a fresh smear on the latch.

S G N O M E G A R D E N
U S B B P E B B L E H P
N L U E U E I M W A O A
F P P N P A R O O R S I
L A A C D I D W R C E N
O T L H N I B E M H T T
W H E E L B A R R O W B
E W T O N T T L A W N R
R A T M U S H R O O M U
B Y E C O M P O S T H S
E E G F O X G L O V E H
D A T E D A F F O D I L

- ☐ ARCH
- ☐ BENCH
- ☐ BIRDBATH
- ☐ COMPOST
- ☐ DAFFODIL
- ☐ FLOWERBED
- ☐ FOXGLOVE
- ☐ GARDEN
- ☐ GNOME
- ☐ HOSE
- ☐ LAWN
- ☐ MOWER
- ☐ MUSHROOM
- ☐ PAINTBRUSH
- ☐ PALETTE
- ☐ PATHWAY
- ☐ PEBBLE
- ☐ SUNDIAL
- ☐ SUNFLOWER
- ☐ WHEELBARROW
- ☐ WORM

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 22

Clue 4 of 6 ●●○

The flower bed around the empty spot was soft, freshly raked soil. Hattie knelt down to look.

E	N	O	H	T	R	E	L	L	I	S	E
A	E	P	A	I	N	T	B	R	U	S	H
S	F	L	G	P	O	R	T	R	A	I	T
E	O	B	R	P	O	T	T	I	N	G	M
L	X	F	E	A	A	J	U	D	G	E	H
A	G	O	E	A	K	R	L	G	K	S	E
D	L	U	N	I	R	E	I	N	A	T	D
Y	O	N	H	H	E	D	P	S	O	T	G
B	V	T	O	A	D	S	T	O	O	L	E
I	E	A	U	W	A	T	E	R	I	N	G
R	I	I	S	R	O	S	E	M	A	R	Y
D	L	N	E	B	I	R	D	B	A	T	H

- ☐ BEARD
- ☐ BIRDBATH
- ☐ EASEL
- ☐ FOUNTAIN
- ☐ FOXGLOVE
- ☐ GATE
- ☐ GREENHOUSE
- ☐ HEDGE
- ☐ JUDGE
- ☐ LADYBIRD
- ☐ PAINTBRUSH
- ☐ PORTRAIT
- ☐ POTTING
- ☐ RAKE
- ☐ ROSEMARY
- ☐ TOADSTOOL
- ☐ TRELLIS
- ☐ TULIP
- ☐ WATERING

The leftover letters spell

☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 23

Clue 5 of 6 ●●○

Next Hattie asked Hugo's mother where he had been all week.

F O U N T A I N S H U D
G O R O B I N W N B B A
T A M O W E R S A U I F
R A P O R T R A I T R F
E B E N C H W A L T D O
L Y C A N V A S A E B D
L T L A V E N D E R A I
I P A T H W A Y S F T L
S U N F L O W E R L H U
H M R O S E M A R Y M E
E R P A I N T B R U S H
D C A M P P A L E T T E

- ☐ BENCH
- ☐ BIRDBATH
- ☐ BUTTERFLY
- ☐ CANVAS
- ☐ DAFFODIL
- ☐ FOUNTAIN
- ☐ LAVENDER
- ☐ MOWER
- ☐ PAINTBRUSH
- ☐ PALETTE
- ☐ PATHWAY
- ☐ PORTRAIT
- ☐ ROBIN
- ☐ ROSEMARY
- ☐ SHED
- ☐ SNAIL
- ☐ SUNFLOWER
- ☐ TRELLIS

The leftover letters spell

Puzzle 24

Clue 6 of 6 ●●○

Through the window of a cottage up the lane, Hattie saw an easel. On it was a half-finished picture with a red hat.

T	B	H	M	E	G	H	E	D	G	E	A
W	L	E	T	U	L	I	P	N	S	F	R
C	H	A	A	O	S	M	E	U	H	E	C
O	I	E	V	R	S	H	O	G	E	N	H
M	F	S	E	E	D	H	R	N	D	C	O
P	L	I	E	L	N	T	R	O	W	E	L
O	A	I	S	E	B	D	N	M	O	A	L
S	W	P	E	H	D	A	E	E	R	M	Y
T	N	R	A	I	I	L	R	R	M	N	H
T	G	A	T	E	C	N	I	R	I	N	O
S	U	N	D	I	A	L	G	N	O	G	C
G	A	R	D	E	N	I	V	Y	G	W	K

- ☐ ARCH
- ☐ BEARD
- ☐ CAN
- ☐ COMPOST
- ☐ FENCE
- ☐ FISHING
- ☐ GARDEN
- ☐ GATE
- ☐ GNOME
- ☐ GREENHOUSE
- ☐ HEDGE
- ☐ HOLLYHOCK
- ☐ IVY
- ☐ LAVENDER
- ☐ LAWN
- ☐ MUSHROOM
- ☐ SEEDLING
- ☐ SHED
- ☐ SUNDIAL
- ☐ TROWEL
- ☐ TULIP
- ☐ WHEELBARROW
- ☐ WORM

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐ ☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 19 to 24.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled out

- ☐ Clara Bell _____
- ☐ Jasper Quill _____
- ☐ Hugo Penn _____
- ☐ Mabel Rook _____

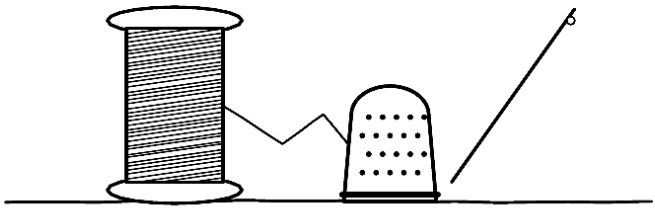
Who did it, and why?

Check your answer with Hattie on page 114.

CASE FIVE

THE QUILT SQUARE

The Quilting Bee



Every Thursday the Thimble Hill quilters meet in the village hall. For a year they have been making a quilt for the hall's hundredth birthday, and its center square shows a stitched map of the whole village. On Thursday afternoon, after the tea break, the center square was gone from the work table. Hattie Bloom was a quilter herself, so she was already in the room.

LEVEL: CURIOUS ●●○

The Suspects

- [ ] **Agnes Pike** is the oldest quilter, ninety-one this spring. She always sits in the same armchair by the window.
- [ ] **Felix Dunn** is the hall caretaker. He whistles while he works and carries a ring of jangling keys.
- [ ] **Hazel Wren** is the youngest quilter. She had to catch the three o'clock bus to visit her grandmother.
- [ ] **Iris Cole** leads the quilting bee and loves fancy stitching with shiny gold thread.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

Puzzle 25

Clue 1 of 6 ●●○

Hattie thought back. The square was on the table at four when the tea was poured, and gone when the cups were cleared.

C	A	R	E	T	A	K	E	R	S	I	T
Q	M	A	P	W	B	E	M	O	A	A	N
U	B	P	I	S	I	T	B	O	T	P	T
I	I	A	N	A	S	R	R	F	I	P	F
L	N	T	C	U	C	I	O	S	N	L	A
T	D	C	U	C	U	A	I	C	V	I	B
H	I	H	S	E	I	N	D	I	I	Q	R
I	N	W	H	R	T	G	E	S	L	U	I
M	G	O	I	O	S	L	R	S	L	E	C
B	A	R	O	F	O	E	Y	O	A	T	E
L	R	K	N	T	H	P	E	R	G	T	E
E	A	B	U	T	T	O	N	S	E	A	M

- ☐ APPLIQUE
- ☐ BINDING
- ☐ BISCUITS
- ☐ BUTTON
- ☐ CARETAKER
- ☐ EMBROIDERY
- ☐ FABRIC
- ☐ HOOP
- ☐ MAP
- ☐ PATCHWORK
- ☐ PINCUSHION
- ☐ QUILT
- ☐ ROOF
- ☐ SATIN
- ☐ SAUCER
- ☐ SCISSORS
- ☐ SEAM
- ☐ THIMBLE
- ☐ TRIANGLE
- ☐ VILLAGE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐

Puzzle 26

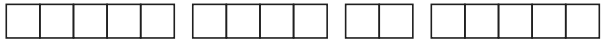
Clue 2 of 6 ●●○

Hattie checked the bus timetable pinned by the door, and remembered waving goodbye.

H E F L A N N E L A P Z
E M D I A M O N D L I S
L B C S T A R P E T N C
F R A R M C H A I R C I
T O R P N B R T H I U S
M I E A E A I C U A S S
E D T T E T B H N N H O
A E A T D T B W D G I R
S R K E L I O O R L O S
U Y E R E N N R E E N A
R T R N T G H K D M A P
E B I R T H D A Y R E E

- ☐ ARMCHAIR
- ☐ BATTING
- ☐ BIRTHDAY
- ☐ CARETAKER
- ☐ DIAMOND
- ☐ EMBROIDERY
- ☐ FLANNEL
- ☐ HUNDRED
- ☐ MAP
- ☐ MEASURE
- ☐ NEEDLE
- ☐ PATCHWORK
- ☐ PATTERN
- ☐ PINCUSHION
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ SCISSORS
- ☐ STAR
- ☐ TRIANGLE

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 27

Clue 3 of 6 ●●○

On the floorboards under the work table, something glinted in the afternoon sun.

A	E	G	G	I	N	G	H	A	M	O	L
T	M	D	B	I	R	T	H	D	A	Y	T
H	B	H	B	U	C	K	E	T	R	E	A
I	R	B	D	S	E	W	I	N	G	W	O
M	O	S	C	I	S	S	O	R	S	C	A
B	I	S	C	U	I	T	S	N	I	S	R
L	D	P	A	S	T	L	O	L	R	Q	M
E	E	O	M	O	L	G	A	E	O	U	C
N	R	O	C	A	A	C	C	D	T	A	H
H	Y	L	H	X	P	U	E	F	D	R	A
C	A	R	E	T	A	K	E	R	L	E	I
O	O	H	M	S	T	I	T	C	H	R	R

- ☐ ARMCHAIR
- ☐ BIRTHDAY
- ☐ BISCUITS
- ☐ BOBBIN
- ☐ BUCKET
- ☐ CALICO
- ☐ CARETAKER
- ☐ COTTON
- ☐ EMBROIDERY
- ☐ GINGHAM
- ☐ HALL
- ☐ HEM
- ☐ HEXAGON
- ☐ LADDER
- ☐ MAP
- ☐ SAUCER
- ☐ SCISSORS
- ☐ SEWING
- ☐ SPOOL
- ☐ SQUARE
- ☐ STITCH
- ☐ THIMBLE

The leftover letters spell

☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐

☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 28

Clue 4 of 6 ●●○

Hattie asked the other quilters about Agnes, and every one of them said the same.

V	I	L	L	A	G	E	A	P	G	S	N
M	T	E	A	C	U	P	H	I	E	P	S
A	P	P	L	I	Q	U	E	N	N	O	T
P	G	I	N	G	H	A	M	C	T	O	H
B	A	E	V	E	R	E	B	U	R	L	R
R	U	T	L	E	P	L	R	S	I	E	E
S	F	T	T	A	N	T	O	H	A	V	A
H	E	T	T	E	D	E	I	I	N	E	D
R	U	A	D	O	R	D	D	O	G	L	L
G	C	L	M	H	N	N	E	N	L	V	A
A	O	B	O	R	D	E	R	R	E	E	C
G	N	E	E	D	L	E	Y	I	R	T	E

- ☐ APPLIQUE
- ☐ BORDER
- ☐ BUTTON
- ☐ EMBROIDERY
- ☐ GINGHAM
- ☐ GOLDEN
- ☐ GUTTER
- ☐ HEM
- ☐ LACE
- ☐ LADDER
- ☐ MAP
- ☐ NEEDLE
- ☐ PATTERN
- ☐ PINCUSHION
- ☐ SEAM
- ☐ SPOOL
- ☐ TAPE
- ☐ TEACUP
- ☐ THREAD
- ☐ TRIANGLE
- ☐ VELVET
- ☐ VILLAGE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 29

Clue 5 of 6 ●●○

Hattie heard loud whistling from above, then the clank of a bucket. She went outside to look up.

B	B	G	O	L	D	E	N	S	T	A	R
A	G	A	F	E	R	O	G	L	A	C	E
S	U	L	T	U	T	N	E	E	D	L	E
K	T	I	S	T	I	F	A	B	R	I	C
E	T	A	O	D	I	A	M	O	N	D	A
T	E	C	N	X	W	N	A	R	S	P	R
M	R	I	H	O	O	P	G	D	N	A	E
U	B	S	H	U	N	D	R	E	D	T	T
P	T	E	A	C	U	P	N	R	O	T	A
N	T	A	P	P	L	I	Q	U	E	E	K
H	E	M	V	E	L	V	E	T	R	R	E
V	I	L	L	A	G	E	O	O	F	N	R

- ☐ APPLIQUE
- ☐ BASKET
- ☐ BATTING
- ☐ BINDING
- ☐ BORDER
- ☐ CARETAKER
- ☐ COTTON
- ☐ DIAMOND
- ☐ FABRIC
- ☐ GOLDEN
- ☐ GUTTER
- ☐ HOOP
- ☐ HUNDRED
- ☐ LACE
- ☐ LINEN
- ☐ MEASURE
- ☐ NEEDLE
- ☐ PATTERN
- ☐ SEAM
- ☐ STAR
- ☐ TEACUP
- ☐ VELVET
- ☐ VILLAGE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 30

Clue 6 of 6 ●●○

In Iris's sewing basket, Hattie saw a sketch of the village map with one new shape drawn in the middle.

A	I	B	O	B	B	I	N	G	R	I	L
T	R	S	B	I	S	C	U	I	T	S	I
H	G	M	W	R	A	M	B	N	N	P	N
I	H	O	C	T	E	T	O	G	S	I	E
M	T	E	L	H	A	E	R	H	Q	N	N
B	H	S	X	D	A	P	D	A	U	C	C
L	R	T	D	A	E	I	E	M	A	U	A
E	E	I	T	Y	G	N	R	O	R	S	L
P	A	T	C	H	W	O	R	K	E	H	I
A	D	C	F	L	A	N	N	E	L	I	C
D	D	H	D	I	A	M	O	N	D	O	O
A	S	T	A	S	E	W	I	N	G	N	R

- ☐ ARMCHAIR
- ☐ BIRTHDAY
- ☐ BISCUITS
- ☐ BOBBIN
- ☐ BORDER
- ☐ CALICO
- ☐ DIAMOND
- ☐ FLANNEL
- ☐ GINGHAM
- ☐ GOLDEN
- ☐ HEM
- ☐ HEXAGON
- ☐ LINEN
- ☐ PATCHWORK
- ☐ PINCUSHION
- ☐ SEWING
- ☐ SQUARE
- ☐ STITCH
- ☐ TAPE
- ☐ THIMBLE
- ☐ THREAD

The leftover letters spell



Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 25 to 30.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Agnes Pike _____
- ☐ Felix Dunn _____
- ☐ Hazel Wren _____
- ☐ Iris Cole _____

Who Did It, and Why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

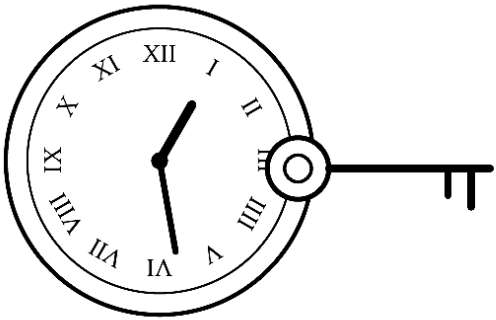
_____

Check your answer with Hattie on page 114.

Case Six

The Clock That Stopped

The Town Hall Tower



The town hall clock has kept time for Thimble Hill for a hundred years. Each Sunday it is wound with a big brass key that hangs on a hook inside the tower. On the morning of the village fete, the clock stopped, and the key was missing from its hook. Without the clock, nobody knew when the fete would open. The mayor sent for Hattie Bloom.

Level: Curious ●●○

The Suspects

- [ ] **Mayor Otto Briggs** is round and jolly and wears a tall hat. He is terribly afraid of heights.
- [ ] **Winnie Shaw** is the clock keeper, the only person who winds the clock each week.
- [ ] **Dot Fairley** leads the church choir and holds practice very early in the morning.
- [ ] **Sam Ruddle** is twelve and mad about clocks. He mends old watches at his kitchen table and always has a little oil on his fingers.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

Puzzle 31

Clue 1 of 6 ●●○

Hattie looked up at the clock face. Both hands pointed to a quarter past five, just as the sun came up.

B S T N H H S E C B L O
I T S A U Y C C S A K P
R E E L P M R R S N S E
T E C A I N E T D N U N
H P O R G Z W R I E N D
D L N M E O D P A R R U
A E D E O P R E L L I L
Y D W I N D I N G S S U
S T A I R S V A C T E M
T W E A T H E R V A N E
S P R I N G R D A L K W
N P O L I S H B E L L E

- ☐ ALARM
- ☐ BANNER
- ☐ BELL
- ☐ BIRTHDAY
- ☐ CAKE
- ☐ DIAL
- ☐ HYMN
- ☐ NUMERALS
- ☐ PENDULUM
- ☐ PIGEON
- ☐ POLISH
- ☐ SCREWDRIVER
- ☐ SECOND
- ☐ SPRING
- ☐ STAIRS
- ☐ STALL
- ☐ STEEPLE
- ☐ SUNRISE
- ☐ TWEEZERS
- ☐ WEATHERVANE
- ☐ WINDING

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 32

Clue 2 of 6 ●●○

Hattie asked about the clock keeper. The mayor dabbed his forehead and explained.

W	W	E	A	T	H	E	R	V	A	N	E
C	H	U	R	C	H	T	O	W	E	R	L
I	N	M	A	Y	O	R	B	S	N	L	L
P	B	S	B	I	E	G	R	R	E	L	R
E	U	U	I	W	A	A	W	B	A	E	S
N	N	N	R	A	E	W	R	H	D	S	A
D	T	R	T	G	Y	E	N	D	E	A	S
U	I	I	H	L	N	W	A	L	C	E	W
L	N	S	D	N	O	L	S	T	A	L	L
U	G	E	A	T	I	C	K	I	N	G	E
M	E	P	Y	T	W	E	E	Z	E	R	S
K	S	C	R	E	W	D	R	I	V	E	R

- ☐ BELL
- ☐ BIRTHDAY
- ☐ BRASS
- ☐ BUNTING
- ☐ CAN
- ☐ CHURCH
- ☐ COGWHEEL
- ☐ GEARS
- ☐ LADDER
- ☐ MAYOR
- ☐ PENDULUM
- ☐ SCREWDRIVER
- ☐ SPANNER
- ☐ STALL
- ☐ SUNRISE
- ☐ TICKING
- ☐ TOWER
- ☐ TOWNHALL
- ☐ TWEEZERS
- ☐ WEATHERVANE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 33

Clue 3 of 6 ●●○

Hattie climbed the narrow stone stairs inside the tower. Halfway up, her hand slid on something slippery.

W	E	A	T	H	E	R	V	A	N	E	O
I	D	S	L	O	S	B	R	A	S	S	W
W	A	T	C	H	C	I	C	C	N	T	I
H	W	E	N	E	R	P	N	O	S	T	N
T	N	E	U	C	E	A	M	G	M	B	D
I	H	P	M	E	W	R	O	W	I	U	I
C	A	L	E	N	D	A	R	H	N	N	N
K	N	E	R	T	R	D	N	E	U	T	G
I	D	H	A	U	I	E	I	E	T	I	E
N	S	O	L	R	V	Y	N	L	E	N	A
G	A	U	S	Y	E	I	G	R	R	G	R
A	I	R	L	K	R	C	H	O	I	R	S

- ☐ BRASS
- ☐ BUNTING
- ☐ CALENDAR
- ☐ CAN
- ☐ CENTURY
- ☐ CHOIR
- ☐ COGWHEEL
- ☐ DAWN
- ☐ GEARS
- ☐ HANDS
- ☐ HOUR
- ☐ KEY
- ☐ MINUTE
- ☐ MORNING
- ☐ NUMERALS
- ☐ PARADE
- ☐ SCREWDRIVER
- ☐ SINGING
- ☐ STEEPLE
- ☐ TICKING
- ☐ WATCH
- ☐ WEATHERVANE
- ☐ WINDING

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 34

Clue 4 of 6 ●●○

At the top of the tower, Hattie looked down at the square far below and thought about the mayor.

O	S	L	S	U	N	D	I	A	L	T	T
M	I	C	E	N	T	U	R	Y	W	T	O
O	W	S	R	I	L	E	C	C	I	O	N
R	P	T	I	E	N	L	H	H	N	W	U
N	O	E	B	N	W	N	O	I	D	N	M
I	L	E	A	I	G	D	I	M	I	H	E
N	I	P	O	L	R	I	R	E	N	A	R
G	S	L	F	E	A	T	N	I	G	L	A
T	H	E	N	E	C	R	H	G	V	L	L
H	A	N	D	S	T	A	M	D	C	E	S
L	A	I	C	A	L	E	N	D	A	R	R
B	M	B	C	H	U	R	C	H	U	Y	P

- ☐ ALARM
- ☐ BANNER
- ☐ BIRTHDAY
- ☐ CALENDAR
- ☐ CAN
- ☐ CENTURY
- ☐ CHIME
- ☐ CHOIR
- ☐ CHURCH
- ☐ FETE
- ☐ HANDS
- ☐ MORNING
- ☐ NUMERALS
- ☐ OIL
- ☐ POLISH
- ☐ SCREWDRIVER
- ☐ SINGING
- ☐ SPANNER
- ☐ STEEPLE
- ☐ SUNDIAL
- ☐ TOWNHALL
- ☐ WINDING

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐

Puzzle 35

Clue 5 of 6 ●●○

From the church across the square, Hattie heard singing, and she remembered the choir practice.

D	A	K	O	M	T	I	C	K	I	N	G
T	L	G	E	A	R	S	C	W	A	F	S
S	A	S	I	Y	N	O	A	G	S	E	T
U	R	C	L	O	T	H	L	S	E	T	O
N	M	O	I	R	W	C	E	I	C	E	W
D	N	G	P	M	E	L	N	N	O	G	N
I	P	W	O	I	E	O	D	G	N	C	H
A	A	H	L	N	Z	C	A	I	D	H	A
L	R	E	I	U	E	K	R	N	G	I	L
A	A	E	S	T	R	P	T	G	D	M	L
A	D	L	H	E	S	Q	U	A	R	E	W
W	E	A	T	H	E	R	V	A	N	E	N

- ☐ ALARM
- ☐ CALENDAR
- ☐ CHIME
- ☐ CLOCK
- ☐ CLOTH
- ☐ COGWHEEL
- ☐ FETE
- ☐ GEARS
- ☐ KEY
- ☐ MAYOR
- ☐ MINUTE
- ☐ PARADE
- ☐ POLISH
- ☐ SECOND
- ☐ SINGING
- ☐ SPRING
- ☐ SQUARE
- ☐ SUNDIAL
- ☐ TICKING
- ☐ TOCK
- ☐ TOWNHALL
- ☐ TWEEZERS
- ☐ WEATHERVANE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 36

Clue 6 of 6 ●●○

On a shelf in the tower, Hattie found an empty tin of brass polish and a soft cloth, both still warm from use.

S	T	S	C	L	H	D	I	A	L	B	C
U	O	I	L	A	S	T	A	L	L	A	A
N	E	N	O	D	P	M	K	T	H	N	L
R	B	G	C	D	A	I	E	W	O	N	E
I	U	I	K	E	N	N	G	E	O	E	N
S	N	N	C	R	N	U	Y	E	K	R	D
E	T	G	H	W	E	T	A	Z	O	S	A
B	I	A	O	E	R	E	U	E	I	N	R
D	N	N	I	N	U	M	E	R	A	L	S
A	G	G	R	R	P	O	L	S	Y	I	S
W	A	T	C	H	S	C	H	U	R	C	H
N	T	O	W	N	H	A	L	L	H	E	D

- ☐ BANNER
- ☐ BUNTING
- ☐ CALENDAR
- ☐ CENTURY
- ☐ CHOIR
- ☐ CHURCH
- ☐ CLOCK
- ☐ DAWN
- ☐ DIAL
- ☐ HOOK
- ☐ LADDER
- ☐ MINUTE
- ☐ NUMERALS
- ☐ OIL
- ☐ PIGEON
- ☐ SINGING
- ☐ SPANNER
- ☐ STAIRS
- ☐ STALL
- ☐ SUNRISE
- ☐ TOWNHALL
- ☐ TWEEZERS
- ☐ WATCH

The leftover letters spell

Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 31 to 36.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Mayor Otto Briggs _____
- ☐ Winnie Shaw _____
- ☐ Dot Fairley _____
- ☐ Sam Ruddle _____

Who Did It, and Why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

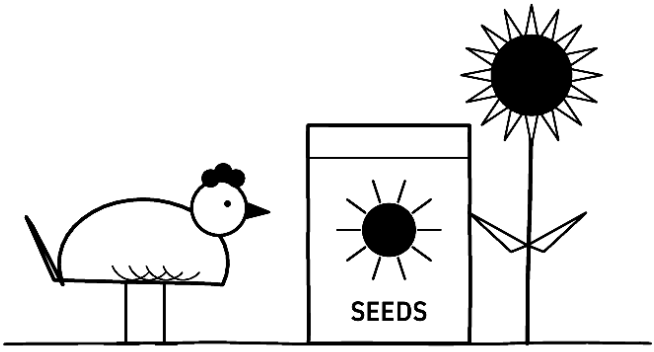
_____

Check your answer with Hattie on page 114.

CASE SEVEN

THE SWAPPED SEEDS

The Seed Swap



Every spring Thimble Hill holds a seed swap in the old barn. The star of the show is a little paper packet of Giant Moon pumpkin seeds, kept in a tin on the back shelf. Last year a Giant Moon pumpkin from these seeds won the county prize. This year, when Hattie Bloom opened the tin for the raffle, the packet was full of striped sunflower seeds instead.

LEVEL: CURIOUS ●●○

The Suspects

- [ ] **Gil Barrow** grows the biggest pumpkins in the county. His boots are always caked in mud from the fields.
- [ ] **Poppy Vance** runs the flower shop and adores sunflowers.
- [ ] **Walt Kemp** runs the seed swap. He was in charge of the soup pot at lunchtime.
- [ ] **June Ashby** keeps a flock of chickens and carries a bag of sunflower seeds for them wherever she goes.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

PUZZLE 37

CLUE 1 OF 6 ●●○

Hattie asked when the packet was last checked. Walt said he had looked inside it just before everyone sat down to eat.

H	A	Y	L	O	F	T	R	T	H	N	E
S	Q	S	C	A	R	E	C	R	O	W	L
G	U	W	A	P	B	P	H	I	O	E	S
A	E	A	P	M	I	R	N	R	W	P	E
R	U	E	U	N	O	O	R	O	C	N	E
L	E	C	S	T	C	A	R	R	O	T	D
I	U	R	C	E	B	T	D	A	R	T	L
C	A	A	L	L	O	T	M	E	N	T	I
P	R	B	E	A	N	S	T	A	L	K	N
T	L	E	U	P	L	A	N	T	I	N	G
N	H	C	S	U	N	F	L	O	W	E	R
W	H	G	R	E	E	N	H	O	U	S	E

- ☐ ALLOTMENT
- ☐ BEANSTALK
- ☐ CARROT
- ☐ CORN
- ☐ CUCUMBER
- ☐ GARLIC
- ☐ GREENHOUSE
- ☐ HAYLOFT
- ☐ ONION
- ☐ PARSNIP
- ☐ PLANTING
- ☐ QUEUE
- ☐ SCARECROW
- ☐ SEEDLING
- ☐ SUNFLOWER
- ☐ TRACTOR
- ☐ TROWEL
- ☐ WHEELBARROW

THE LEFTOVER LETTERS SPELL

Puzzle 38

Clue 2 of 6 ●●○

Hattie asked who was ladling the soup, and the whole queue pointed at the same man.

W W H E E L B A R R O W
B A S K E T T R O W E L
S P C A H A R V E S T L
P U T H W P S Q U A S H
R M N A I G E O S S D D
O P C F G C H A R D L M
U K O E L N K E P E L A
T I O R E O S E I O A R
I N P E V T W F N I D R
N N R O O S T E R S L O
G G S O W I N G R S E W
O U B B E E T R O O T P

- ☐ BASKET
- ☐ BEETROOT
- ☐ BOOTS
- ☐ BREAD
- ☐ CHARD
- ☐ CHICKENS
- ☐ COOP
- ☐ EGGS
- ☐ FIELD
- ☐ GREENHOUSE
- ☐ HARVEST
- ☐ LADLE
- ☐ MARROW
- ☐ PEAPOD
- ☐ PUMPKIN
- ☐ ROOSTER
- ☐ SOWING
- ☐ SPROUT
- ☐ SQUASH
- ☐ SUNFLOWER
- ☐ TIN
- ☐ TROWEL
- ☐ WHEELBARROW

The leftover letters spell

Puzzle 39

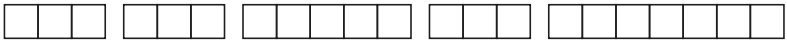
Clue 3 of 6 ●●○

Hattie poured a few seeds into her palm. They were long and gray, with black stripes.

F	T	S	H	C	U	C	U	M	B	E	R
A	G	W	C	P	L	A	N	T	I	N	G
R	R	A	H	A	C	A	B	B	A	G	E
M	E	P	I	E	R	T	O	M	A	T	O
E	E	N	C	K	M	E	E	W	O	S	L
R	N	M	K	A	R	A	C	O	E	E	E
W	H	E	E	L	B	A	R	R	O	W	T
O	O	A	N	E	D	T	D	R	O	S	T
N	U	D	S	A	E	R	E	I	O	W	U
I	S	O	S	E	T	R	I	P	S	W	C
O	E	W	B	S	Q	U	A	S	H	H	E
N	A	L	L	O	T	M	E	N	T	E	D

- ☐ ALLOTMENT
- ☐ BEETROOT
- ☐ CABBAGE
- ☐ CHICKENS
- ☐ CUCUMBER
- ☐ FARMER
- ☐ GREENHOUSE
- ☐ KALE
- ☐ LETTUCE
- ☐ MARROW
- ☐ MEADOW
- ☐ ONION
- ☐ PLANTING
- ☐ RADISH
- ☐ SCARECROW
- ☐ SQUASH
- ☐ SWAP
- ☐ TOMATO
- ☐ WHEELBARROW

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 40

Clue 4 of 6 ●●○

Poppy's shop assistant told Hattie that Poppy had not been at the barn at all.

P T U R N I P O P P G W
B Q Y S T P A Y E N S H
G E U S W A P D I T H E
R H A E O C M L O S E E
E P S N U K D O E C N L
E U P W S E B D E A S B
N M R I E T L G T R P A
H P I S F E A T H E R R
O K N H I B A L C C O R
U I G F B A R N K R U O
S N H A Y L O F T O T W
E O C R A F F L E W L D

- ☐ BARN
- ☐ BEANSTALK
- ☐ BOOTS
- ☐ CABBAGE
- ☐ FEATHER
- ☐ FIELD
- ☐ GREENHOUSE
- ☐ HAYLOFT
- ☐ HENS
- ☐ PACKET
- ☐ PUMPKIN
- ☐ QUEUE
- ☐ RAFFLE
- ☐ SCARECROW
- ☐ SEEDLING
- ☐ SPRING
- ☐ SPROUT
- ☐ SWAP
- ☐ TURNIP
- ☐ WHEELBARROW

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 41

Clue 5 of 6 ●●○

Hattie looked at the floor of the back room, which had been swept that morning. It was still spotless.

R	S	F	A	R	M	E	R	P	N	O	H
C	O	M	B	S	O	B	R	E	A	D	A
U	W	O	A	U	O	N	D	A	B	M	R
C	I	S	S	O	T	U	I	P	E	E	V
U	N	E	K	T	F	R	P	O	A	A	E
M	G	E	E	N	E	T	A	D	N	D	S
B	G	D	T	T	A	R	H	C	S	O	T
E	A	L	L	O	T	M	E	N	T	W	E
R	R	I	K	M	H	E	N	S	A	O	F
L	L	N	A	A	E	L	A	D	L	E	R
O	I	G	L	T	R	P	A	C	K	E	T
T	C	O	E	O	R	R	A	F	F	L	E

- ☐ ALLOTMENT
- ☐ BASKET
- ☐ BEANSTALK
- ☐ BREAD
- ☐ CUCUMBER
- ☐ FARMER
- ☐ FEATHER
- ☐ GARLIC
- ☐ HARVEST
- ☐ HENS
- ☐ KALE
- ☐ LADLE
- ☐ MEADOW
- ☐ ONION
- ☐ PACKET
- ☐ PEAPOD
- ☐ RAFFLE
- ☐ ROOSTER
- ☐ SEEDLING
- ☐ SOUP
- ☐ SOWING
- ☐ TIN
- ☐ TOMATO
- ☐ TRACTOR

The leftover letters spell

☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 42

Clue 6 of 6 ●●○

At the bottom of the tin, under the packet, Hattie found something soft and speckled.

A	F	E	T	R	A	C	T	O	R	A	B
T	S	O	U	P	L	E	T	T	U	C	E
T	C	F	E	A	T	H	E	R	H	E	E
U	A	S	U	N	F	L	O	W	E	R	T
R	R	R	R	C	U	C	U	M	B	E	R
N	E	O	W	M	E	A	D	O	W	O	O
I	C	C	H	I	C	K	E	N	S	N	O
P	R	C	E	S	E	E	D	S	A	I	T
S	O	H	G	I	N	M	A	R	R	O	W
T	W	A	G	H	L	A	D	L	E	N	E
P	A	R	S	N	I	P	E	A	P	O	D
T	I	D	N	P	L	A	N	T	I	N	G

- ☐ BEETROOT
- ☐ CHARD
- ☐ CHICKENS
- ☐ CORN
- ☐ CUCUMBER
- ☐ EGGS
- ☐ FEATHER
- ☐ LADLE
- ☐ LETTUCE
- ☐ MARROW
- ☐ MEADOW
- ☐ ONION
- ☐ PARSNIP
- ☐ PEAPOD
- ☐ PLANTING
- ☐ SCARECROW
- ☐ SEEDS
- ☐ SOUP
- ☐ SUNFLOWER
- ☐ TRACTOR
- ☐ TURNIP

The leftover letters spell

☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐

Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 37 to 42.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Gil Barrow _____
- ☐ Poppy Vance _____
- ☐ Walt Kemp _____
- ☐ June Ashby _____

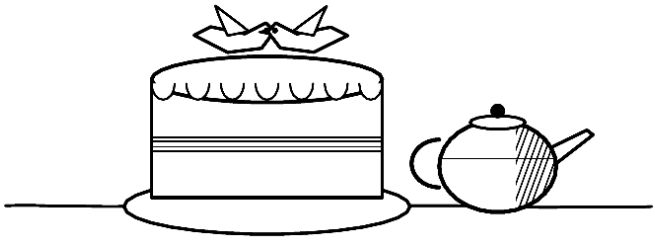
Who Did It, and Why?

Check your answer with Hattie on page 115.

CASE EIGHT

THE DOVES ON THE CAKE

The Copper Kettle Tea Room



Nora and Ben were to be married on Saturday, and their wedding cake was waiting in the Copper Kettle Tea Room under a heavy glass dome. On top sat two tiny white china doves. On Saturday morning the cake was perfect, but the doves were gone. Nora was in tears. Hattie Bloom, who was knitting the bride a shawl, put down her needles and took charge.

LEVEL: SHARP-EYED ●●●

The Suspects

- [ ] **Maisie Fenwick** owns the tea room and keeps the only front-door key.
- [ ] **Leo Hart** is Ben's best man. He was traveling down from the city on Friday night.
- [ ] **Aunt Prudence** is Nora's great-aunt. She is very sentimental and always smells of lavender water.
- [ ] **Kit Morrow** baked the cake. Her wrist is in a bandage after she slipped on a wet floor.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

PUZZLE 43

CLUE 1 OF 6 ●●●

Maisie said the doves were on the cake when she locked up at nine. So they must have gone overnight.

C	L	O	T	T	E	D	M	T	G	T	C
H	H	C	H	I	N	A	M	N	S	O	I
A	H	P	E	D	R	O	I	I	N	C	O
M	N	V	A	Z	O	D	N	F	I	E	P
P	S	I	I	R	D	A	E	N	F	S	E
A	L	P	A	E	G	T	G	E	W	P	O
G	A	E	W	R	T	O	O	F	F	O	N
N	T	N	O	I	T	A	T	I	V	N	I
E	N	I	A	L	E	C	R	O	P	G	E
A	R	E	D	N	E	V	A	L	H	E	S
T	N	G	N	I	T	T	I	N	K	P	I
G	H	T	K	O	O	B	T	S	E	U	G

- ☐ CHAMPAGNE
- ☐ CHINA
- ☐ CLOTTED
- ☐ CONFETTI
- ☐ GUESTBOOK
- ☐ ICING
- ☐ INVITATION
- ☐ KNITTING
- ☐ LAVENDER
- ☐ MARZIPAN
- ☐ ORGANIST
- ☐ PEONIES
- ☐ PHOTOGRAPH
- ☐ PORCELAIN
- ☐ SPONGE
- ☐ TEAROOM
- ☐ TRAIN
- ☐ WEDDING

THE LEFTOVER LETTERS SPELL

Puzzle 44

Clue 2 of 6 ●●●

Hattie asked about the best man. Ben showed her the ticket in Leo's coat pocket.

T	L	P	H	O	T	O	G	R	A	P	H
I	C	H	A	M	P	A	G	N	E	E	O
C	W	N	O	I	T	A	T	I	V	N	I
K	T	I	A	R	A	A	S	S	I	A	S
E	O	L	D	O	M	E	O	A	S	M	C
T	P	O	N	D	L	T	L	R	E	T	O
C	P	I	B	D	E	E	H	I	S	S	N
R	E	V	E	T	C	T	E	B	O	E	E
E	R	E	L	R	S	A	T	B	R	B	S
A	N	O	O	M	Y	E	N	O	H	T	E
M	T	P	R	E	H	S	U	N	L	R	A
B	O	U	Q	U	E	T	A	G	I	C	N

- ☐ AUNT
- ☐ BESTMAN
- ☐ BOUQUET
- ☐ CHAMPAGNE
- ☐ CLOTTED
- ☐ CREAM
- ☐ DOME
- ☐ GUESTBOOK
- ☐ HONEYMOON
- ☐ INVITATION
- ☐ NEEDLES
- ☐ PHOTOGRAPH
- ☐ PORCELAIN
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ ROSES
- ☐ SCONES
- ☐ TIARA
- ☐ TICKET
- ☐ TOPPER
- ☐ USHER
- ☐ VIOLIN

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 45

Clue 3 of 6 ●●●

When Hattie stepped close to the cake, she noticed a sweet, flowery smell in the air.

T	G	H	B	E	S	T	M	A	N	E	O
C	R	U	G	N	I	T	T	I	N	K	R
S	H	L	E	P	A	H	C	O	O	M	G
I	E	A	N	S	S	P	M	E	L	N	A
S	T	L	M	O	T	S	I	L	E	E	N
T	E	E	D	P	O	B	S	Z	D	D	I
E	U	V	A	E	A	M	O	A	R	R	S
R	Q	O	O	P	E	G	Y	O	L	A	T
F	U	L	A	D	O	N	N	E	K	G	M
C	O	N	F	E	T	T	I	E	N	V	E
N	B	I	N	V	I	T	A	T	I	O	N
D	R	E	D	N	E	V	A	L	E	R	H

- ☐ BESTMAN
- ☐ BOUQUET
- ☐ CHAMPAGNE
- ☐ CHAPEL
- ☐ CONFETTI
- ☐ DOVES
- ☐ GARDEN
- ☐ GLASS
- ☐ GUESTBOOK
- ☐ HONEYMOON
- ☐ INVITATION
- ☐ KNITTING
- ☐ LAVENDER
- ☐ MARZIPAN
- ☐ NEEDLES
- ☐ ORGANIST
- ☐ SISTER
- ☐ TEAPOT

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 46

Clue 4 of 6 ●●●

Hattie asked Maisie where she had spent the night. Maisie went pink.

G	U	E	S	T	B	O	O	K	I	M	A
Z	T	L	A	W	E	D	D	I	N	G	I
S	I	E	S	R	E	D	N	E	V	A	L
E	S	E	I	N	O	E	P	M	I	R	M
N	I	A	L	E	C	R	O	P	T	D	A
G	C	S	U	A	C	O	L	R	A	E	R
A	L	R	K	C	R	N	E	E	T	N	Z
P	O	E	P	A	E	P	A	T	I	A	I
M	T	I	E	T	P	R	H	D	O	E	P
A	T	T	R	O	S	I	S	T	N	E	A
H	E	R	T	S	S	P	O	N	G	E	N
C	D	P	H	O	T	O	G	R	A	P	H

- ☐ CAKE
- ☐ CHAMPAGNE
- ☐ CLOTTED
- ☐ DANCE
- ☐ GARDEN
- ☐ GUESTBOOK
- ☐ INVITATION
- ☐ LAVENDER
- ☐ MARZIPAN
- ☐ PEONIES
- ☐ PHOTOGRAPH
- ☐ PORCELAIN
- ☐ SAUCER
- ☐ SPONGE
- ☐ TEAROOM
- ☐ TIERS
- ☐ TOPPER
- ☐ WALTZ
- ☐ WEDDING

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 47

Clue 5 of 6 ●●●

Hattie tried to lift the glass dome herself. It took both hands and all her strength.

N	S	H	A	W	L	C	D	B	A	S	T
I	H	O	T	S	A	O	T	R	L	P	G
A	R	N	E	P	M	N	D	I	B	O	N
L	I	E	V	E	K	F	O	D	U	N	I
E	B	Y	S	R	N	E	M	E	M	G	R
C	B	M	E	F	I	T	S	A	R	E	S
R	O	O	L	U	T	T	C	O	E	A	M
O	N	O	D	M	T	I	O	E	U	R	I
P	S	N	E	E	I	M	N	C	V	A	C
E	R	Y	E	H	N	T	E	K	C	I	T
I	C	I	N	G	G	R	S	E	A	T	V
Y	O	R	G	A	N	I	S	T	N	U	A

- ☐ ALBUM
- ☐ AUNT
- ☐ BRIDE
- ☐ CONFETTI
- ☐ CREAM
- ☐ DOME
- ☐ GROOM
- ☐ HONEYMOON
- ☐ ICING
- ☐ KNITTING
- ☐ NEEDLES
- ☐ ORGANIST
- ☐ PERFUME
- ☐ PORCELAIN
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ RING
- ☐ SAUCER
- ☐ SCONES
- ☐ SHAWL
- ☐ SPONGE
- ☐ TIARA
- ☐ TICKET
- ☐ TOAST
- ☐ VEIL

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 48

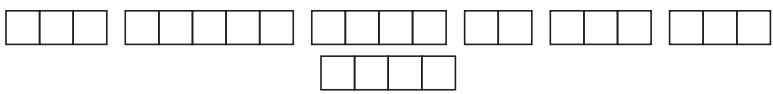
Clue 6 of 6 ●●●

In the tea room's guest book, Hattie found an old photograph of a wedding cake from fifty years ago. On top were two little doves.

W	S	E	S	O	R	G	A	N	I	S	T
A	P	T	B	E	S	T	M	A	N	H	E
L	H	D	O	S	V	I	C	I	N	G	E
T	O	N	S	C	T	E	A	R	O	O	M
Z	T	O	M	O	O	R	G	W	R	U	S
T	O	O	R	N	T	S	E	E	B	S	I
O	G	M	R	E	C	S	C	L	E	E	S
P	R	Y	O	S	H	U	A	N	H	I	T
A	A	E	G	L	A	S	S	O	E	N	E
E	P	N	R	S	P	A	U	N	T	O	R
T	H	O	O	P	E	R	F	U	M	E	W
N	C	H	A	Y	L	I	O	D	K	P	E

- ☐ ALBUM
- ☐ AUNT
- ☐ BESTMAN
- ☐ CHAPEL
- ☐ DOILY
- ☐ GLASS
- ☐ GROOM
- ☐ HONEYMOON
- ☐ ICING
- ☐ ORGANIST
- ☐ PEONIES
- ☐ PERFUME
- ☐ PHOTOGRAPH
- ☐ ROSES
- ☐ SAUCER
- ☐ SCONES
- ☐ SISTER
- ☐ TEAPOT
- ☐ TEAROOM
- ☐ TIERS
- ☐ TOAST
- ☐ TRAIN
- ☐ USHER
- ☐ WALTZ

The leftover letters spell



Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 43 to 48.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Maisie Fenwick _____
- ☐ Leo Hart _____
- ☐ Aunt Prudence _____
- ☐ Kit Morrow _____

Who Did It, and Why?

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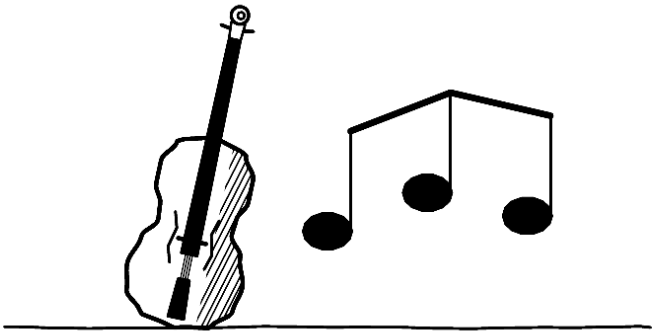
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Check your answer with Hattie on page 115.

CASE NINE

THE HARVEST SONG

The Village Hall



For the harvest concert, the choir director wrote a brand new song called Golden Fields. There was only one copy, written by hand, and it lived on the music stand by the piano. At ten past six on the evening before the concert, the stand was empty. Without the music, there would be no new song. Hattie Bloom sang alto in the choir, so she started asking questions at once.

LEVEL: SHARP-EYED ●●●

The Suspects

- [ ] **Wilma Hart** is the choir's star soprano. She wanted a solo in the new song and did not get one.
- [ ] **Percy Lowe** plays the tuba in the village band, which practices in the shed behind the hall.
- [ ] **Greta Holm** plays the piano for the choir. She wears thick glasses and always has a pocket full of peppermints.
- [ ] **Ned Bly** is the hall cleaner. He sweeps the hall and the front steps every evening.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

Puzzle 49

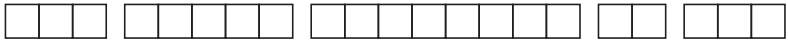
Clue 1 of 6 ●●●

Everyone agreed the music was on the stand when the hall clock struck six, and gone ten minutes later.

N	E	D	L	O	G	S	P	E	T	S	P
I	O	D	N	E	C	S	E	R	C	T	E
L	A	S	R	A	E	H	E	R	L	H	P
O	E	R	M	Y	N	O	M	R	A	H	P
I	S	A	O	U	S	C	I	C	N	T	E
V	S	P	O	T	L	I	G	H	T	E	R
A	A	P	T	E	C	S	V	A	E	N	M
N	B	L	I	P	N	U	I	S	R	I	I
T	A	A	C	M	H	M	D	E	N	R	N
H	T	U	K	U	S	T	A	N	D	A	T
E	O	S	E	R	D	A	T	S	O	L	I
M	N	E	T	T	R	E	C	N	O	C	X

- ☐ ANTHEM
- ☐ APPLAUSE
- ☐ BASS
- ☐ BATON
- ☐ CLARINET
- ☐ CONCERT
- ☐ CONDUCTOR
- ☐ CRESCENDO
- ☐ GOLDEN
- ☐ HARMONY
- ☐ LANTERN
- ☐ MUSIC
- ☐ PEPPERMINT
- ☐ REHEARSAL
- ☐ SPOTLIGHT
- ☐ STAND
- ☐ STEPS
- ☐ TICKET
- ☐ TRUMPET
- ☐ VIOLIN

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 50

Clue 2 of 6 ●●●

From the shed behind the hall came a long, low, wobbly note that went on and on.

P	E	R	R	E	P	P	A	R	W	C	E
M	H	T	Y	H	R	Y	S	E	T	O	N
P	T	S	O	D	N	E	C	S	E	R	C
I	R	W	P	U	M	P	K	I	N	A	O
A	U	S	C	O	N	D	U	C	T	O	R
N	M	W	C	T	T	E	K	S	A	B	E
O	P	U	H	U	Y	L	F	A	E	H	S
P	E	P	P	E	R	M	I	N	T	E	S
N	T	I	L	N	A	T	G	G	L	H	H
H	A	R	V	E	S	T	A	P	H	I	E
L	A	B	M	Y	C	S	P	I	T	T	E
B	U	B	A	C	L	A	R	I	N	E	T

- ☐ APPLES
- ☐ BARLEY
- ☐ BASKET
- ☐ CLARINET
- ☐ CONDUCTOR
- ☐ CRESCENDO
- ☐ CURTAIN
- ☐ CYMBAL
- ☐ ENCORE
- ☐ HARVEST
- ☐ NOTES
- ☐ PEPPERMINT
- ☐ PIANO
- ☐ PUMPKIN
- ☐ RHYTHM
- ☐ SHEAF
- ☐ SHEET
- ☐ SPOTLIGHT
- ☐ TRUMPET
- ☐ WHEAT
- ☐ WRAPPER

The leftover letters spell

Puzzle 51

Clue 3 of 6 ●●●

Under the music stand, Hattie found a crinkly little piece of paper. It was a wrapper.

T	W	R	A	P	P	E	R	O	N	E	T
N	A	T	R	E	C	N	O	C	G	P	E
I	F	L	U	T	E	P	P	A	L	E	R
M	M	E	L	B	E	R	T	G	A	C	C
R	I	N	Y	S	S	S	T	N	S	Y	R
E	C	O	N	D	U	C	T	O	R	M	E
P	V	N	O	L	A	S	W	S	A	B	S
P	I	A	M	E	L	O	D	Y	E	A	C
E	O	R	R	I	P	L	R	A	H	L	E
P	L	P	A	F	P	O	B	A	E	P	N
R	I	O	H	C	A	U	P	F	R	E	D
R	N	S	P	O	T	L	I	G	H	T	O

- ☐ APPLAUSE
- ☐ CHOIR
- ☐ CLEF
- ☐ CONCERT
- ☐ CONDUCTOR
- ☐ CRESCENDO
- ☐ CYMBAL
- ☐ FIELDS
- ☐ FLUTE
- ☐ HARMONY
- ☐ MELODY
- ☐ PEPPERMINT
- ☐ REHEARSAL
- ☐ SOLO
- ☐ SONG
- ☐ SOPRANO
- ☐ SPOTLIGHT
- ☐ STAGE
- ☐ TENOR
- ☐ TREBLE
- ☐ TUBA
- ☐ VIOLIN
- ☐ WRAPPER

The leftover letters spell

☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 52

Clue 4 of 6 ●●●

Hattie asked the people waiting outside if they had seen Ned. They nodded and pointed at his broom.

S	E	T	O	N	M	O	O	R	B	T	N
E	B	E	T	E	N	C	O	R	E	S	D
L	A	S	R	A	E	H	E	R	W	E	O
P	R	Y	E	A	S	O	N	O	S	V	P
P	L	N	B	W	E	R	E	T	E	R	M
A	E	O	L	T	E	U	D	C	B	A	E
Y	Y	M	E	T	P	S	L	U	A	H	T
D	I	R	N	N	G	T	O	D	S	H	U
O	N	A	R	P	O	S	G	N	K	E	L
L	L	H	S	T	A	N	D	O	E	S	F
E	T	N	I	A	T	R	U	C	T	E	P
M	S	P	E	P	P	E	R	M	I	N	T

- ☐ APPLES
- ☐ BARLEY
- ☐ BASKET
- ☐ BROOM
- ☐ CHORUS
- ☐ CONDUCTOR
- ☐ CURTAIN
- ☐ DUET
- ☐ ENCORE
- ☐ FLUTE
- ☐ GOLDEN
- ☐ HARMONY
- ☐ HARVEST
- ☐ LANTERN
- ☐ MELODY
- ☐ NOTES
- ☐ PEPPERMINT
- ☐ REHEARSAL
- ☐ SOPRANO
- ☐ STAND
- ☐ TEMPO
- ☐ TREBLE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 53

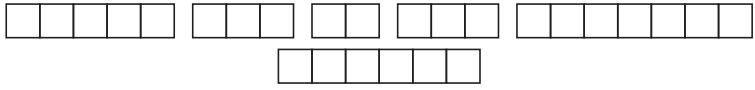
Clue 5 of 6 ●●●

Hattie telephoned Wilma's house. Her husband said she was not home, and told Hattie why.

C	W	I	F	I	E	L	D	S	L	M	A
P	O	D	N	E	C	S	E	R	C	E	W
U	A	N	C	S	M	A	V	E	R	S	E
M	Y	A	C	H	O	C	M	F	S	U	B
P	E	T	S	E	O	U	T	P	E	A	T
K	L	S	H	H	R	R	O	E	T	L	E
I	R	E	E	D	B	T	U	O	M	P	C
N	A	V	A	R	L	A	N	S	S	P	I
N	B	R	F	I	G	I	T	I	N	A	O
G	L	A	G	S	O	N	G	E	E	S	S
O	S	H	E	E	T	E	P	M	U	R	T
S	T	A	G	E	R	O	C	N	E	D	N

- ☐ APPLAUSE
- ☐ BARLEY
- ☐ BATON
- ☐ BROOM
- ☐ CHORUS
- ☐ CLEF
- ☐ CONCERT
- ☐ CRESCENDO
- ☐ CURTAIN
- ☐ DRUM
- ☐ DUET
- ☐ ENCORE
- ☐ FIELDS
- ☐ HARVEST
- ☐ PUMPKIN
- ☐ SHEAF
- ☐ SHEET
- ☐ SONG
- ☐ SPOTLIGHT
- ☐ STAGE
- ☐ STAND
- ☐ TEMPO
- ☐ TRUMPET
- ☐ VERSE

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 54

Clue 6 of 6 ●●●

On the piano lid, Hattie spotted a sheet of fresh music paper with very large, very dark notes.

H C L A R I N E T S G R
A A T N I K P M U P R E
R P T E A W U O B E E C
M P L A N S L S A T P E
O L M A I O B A S S P L
N A H C S P R N C O A L
Y U T Y E R P T Y N R O
R S Y M L A A H T I W N
I E H B P N N E D L O G
O G R A P O R M H T H E
H O T L A N E L B E R T
C M U S F L U T E I R C

- ☐ ALTO
- ☐ ANTHEM
- ☐ APPLAUSE
- ☐ APPLES
- ☐ BASS
- ☐ CELLO
- ☐ CHOIR
- ☐ CLARINET
- ☐ CYMBAL
- ☐ FLUTE
- ☐ GOLDEN
- ☐ HARMONY
- ☐ LANTERN
- ☐ MUSIC
- ☐ PUMPKIN
- ☐ REHEARSAL
- ☐ RHYTHM
- ☐ SOLO
- ☐ SOPRANO
- ☐ STEPS
- ☐ TENOR
- ☐ TREBLE
- ☐ TUBA
- ☐ WRAPPER

The leftover letters spell

Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 49 to 54.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled Out

- ☐ Wilma Hart _____
- ☐ Percy Lowe _____
- ☐ Greta Holm _____
- ☐ Ned Bly _____

Who Did It, and Why?

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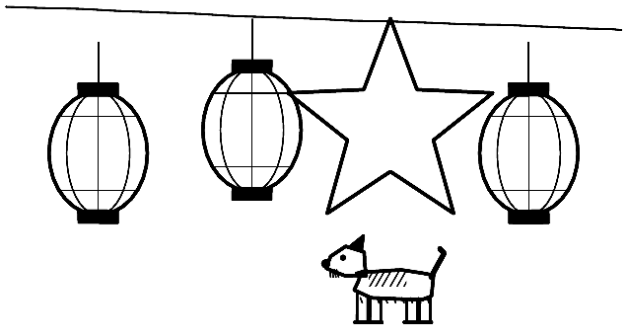
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Check your answer with Hattie on page 115.

Case Ten

The Lantern Parade Star

The Craft Barn



On the first dark evening of autumn, the whole of Thimble Hill walks through the lanes carrying paper lanterns. At the front goes a big paper star lantern on a long pole. This year it was made in the craft barn, and it was left there to dry. At sunset, an hour before the parade, the star was gone. Hattie Bloom pulled on her coat, clipped on Pickle's lead, and went to find it.

Level: Sharp-Eyed ●●●

The Suspects

- [ ] **Arlo Finch** is the lamplighter. Every evening he walks the lanes with his long pole, lighting the old gas lamps.
- [ ] **Bess Tully** teaches the craft class and made the star herself, covered in glitter.
- [ ] **Cyril Marsh** grumbles that the parade is too noisy. He sits on the parish council.
- [ ] **Pickle** is Hattie's own scruffy terrier, who loves anything that rustles.

Tick a box when a clue rules that suspect out.

Notes

Puzzle 55

Clue 1 of 6 ●●●

Bess said the star was hanging in the barn at four, but by dusk the hook was empty.

T C P R O C E S S I O N
C H E S T N U T D U S K
M I L A M P P O S T H S
I L M O O R S S A L C Q
T D G G O H E G D E H U
T R L E N S G T A R W I
E E I A L N S G O N N R
N N T N I R P W A P O R
S E T T G A P P L E Y E
B R E T H G I L P M A L
Y E R D T L A N T E R N
M U S T E K N A L B C K

- ☐ APPLE
- ☐ BLANKET
- ☐ CHESTNUT
- ☐ CHILDREN
- ☐ CLASSROOM
- ☐ CRAYON
- ☐ DUSK
- ☐ GLITTER
- ☐ HEDGEHOG
- ☐ LAMPLIGHTER
- ☐ LAMPPOST
- ☐ LANTERN
- ☐ MEETING
- ☐ MITTENS
- ☐ MOONLIGHT
- ☐ PAWPRINT
- ☐ PROCESSION
- ☐ SQUIRREL

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 56

Clue 2 of 6 ●●●

Hattie looked out at the lane. One by one, the old lamps were flickering on.

A	T	R	T	M	T	L	O	W	P	T	A
S	E	L	E	O	O	S	I	L	R	W	G
E	R	C	S	O	F	Q	C	A	O	I	H
L	R	H	N	N	F	U	L	M	C	L	P
T	I	I	U	L	E	I	A	P	E	I	A
S	E	L	S	I	E	R	S	L	S	G	W
I	R	D	N	G	C	R	S	I	S	H	P
H	T	R	I	H	N	E	R	G	I	T	R
W	A	E	I	T	G	L	O	H	O	T	I
B	O	N	F	I	R	E	O	T	N	H	N
E	G	N	I	R	T	S	M	E	L	A	T
S	R	O	S	S	I	C	S	R	M	P	S

- ☐ BARN
- ☐ BONFIRE
- ☐ CHILDREN
- ☐ CLASSROOM
- ☐ LAMPLIGHTER
- ☐ MARCHING
- ☐ MOONLIGHT
- ☐ PAWPRINT
- ☐ PROCESSION
- ☐ SCISSORS
- ☐ SQUIRREL
- ☐ STRING
- ☐ SUNSET
- ☐ TERRIER
- ☐ TOFFEE
- ☐ TWILIGHT
- ☐ WHISTLE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 57

Clue 3 of 6 ●●●

The council clerk told Hattie that the meeting had gone on far too long, as usual.

E E F F O T P A P E R L
M O O R S S A L C C Y A
R I L C C F R A C S W M
S T O O B A A G S C I P
C N A U A T D O M I E L
O T U N T S E H C S U I
C E T C F O W E O S S G
O S U I A P O G N O S H
A T M L R P L D K R I T
L A N E C M G E E S T E
N R E T N A L H R E T R
I M O O N L I G H T N G

- ☐ AUTUMN
- ☐ BOOTS
- ☐ CHESTNUT
- ☐ CLASSROOM
- ☐ COAT
- ☐ COCOA
- ☐ CONKER
- ☐ COUNCIL
- ☐ CRAFT
- ☐ GLOW
- ☐ HEDGEHOG
- ☐ LAMPLIGHTER
- ☐ LAMPPOST
- ☐ LANE
- ☐ LANTERN
- ☐ MOONLIGHT
- ☐ PAPER
- ☐ PARADE
- ☐ SCARF
- ☐ SCISSORS
- ☐ STAR
- ☐ TISSUE
- ☐ TOFFEE

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐ ☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 58

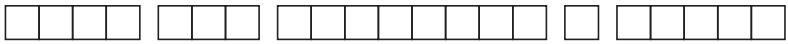
Clue 4 of 6 ●●●

Hattie peeked into the classroom next door, where a dozen children were gluing tissue paper.

B	E	P	M	S	Q	U	I	R	R	E	L
S	S	R	C	I	R	E	T	T	I	L	G
N	W	O	A	A	T	E	K	N	A	L	B
O	A	C	N	E	U	T	L	S	T	I	A
B	P	E	D	G	R	T	E	D	E	C	R
B	A	S	L	A	N	I	U	N	D	N	N
I	W	S	E	T	C	I	F	M	S	U	W
R	P	I	K	V	S	E	H	N	N	O	P
E	R	O	H	E	A	I	U	C	O	C	I
D	I	N	N	G	T	E	H	L	R	B	A
I	N	R	E	T	N	A	L	W	G	A	C
C	T	L	A	S	S	Y	H	D	R	U	M

- ☐ AUTUMN
- ☐ BARN
- ☐ BASKET
- ☐ BLANKET
- ☐ BONFIRE
- ☐ CANDLE
- ☐ CIDER
- ☐ COUNCIL
- ☐ DRUM
- ☐ GLITTER
- ☐ GLUE
- ☐ HAT
- ☐ LANTERN
- ☐ LEAVES
- ☐ MARCHING
- ☐ MITTENS
- ☐ PAWPRINT
- ☐ PROCESSION
- ☐ PUDDLE
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ SQUIRREL
- ☐ WHISTLE
- ☐ WOOLLY

The leftover letters spell



Puzzle 59

Clue 5 of 6 ●●●

On the barn floor, in the dust, Hattie saw a trail of small, round prints.

S M M U D D T B O O T S
Q L A M P L I G H T E R
U A R T E K S A B Y K E
I M C S P C S A L C N I
R P H W C L U C I R A R
R P I H Y A E R C A L R
E O N I L S R A N Y B E
L S G S L S I F U O W T
D T L T O R F T O N P R
D A U L O O N A C O R N
U R E E W O O R E D I C
P I N T S M B A O C O C

- ☐ ACORN
- ☐ BASKET
- ☐ BLANKET
- ☐ BONFIRE
- ☐ BOOTS
- ☐ CIDER
- ☐ CLASSROOM
- ☐ COCOA
- ☐ COUNCIL
- ☐ CRAFT
- ☐ CRAYON
- ☐ GLUE
- ☐ LAMPLIGHTER
- ☐ LAMPPOST
- ☐ MARCHING
- ☐ PUDDLE
- ☐ SCARF
- ☐ SQUIRREL
- ☐ STAR
- ☐ TERRIER
- ☐ TISSUE
- ☐ WHISTLE
- ☐ WOOLLY

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐

Puzzle 60

Clue 6 of 6 ●●●

Hattie followed a long piece of chewed string out of the barn, along the lane and through her own front door.

G	N	I	R	T	S	O	P	P	M	A	L
T	T	U	N	T	S	E	H	C	L	M	N
H	H	T	N	I	R	P	W	A	P	E	O
E	G	C	T	S	T	M	N	N	R	E	I
T	I	O	R	H	U	E	O	D	R	T	S
E	L	U	E	R	G	Y	L	L	R	I	S
K	I	N	D	I	A	I	A	E	I	N	E
N	W	C	I	R	H	P	L	N	B	G	C
A	T	I	C	C	P	G	L	N	B	E	O
L	D	L	H	L	E	E	F	F	O	T	R
B	O	R	E	K	N	O	C	M	N	O	P
R	E	P	A	P	A	R	A	D	E	E	M

- ☐ APPLE
- ☐ BLANKET
- ☐ CANDLE
- ☐ CHESTNUT
- ☐ CHILDREN
- ☐ CIDER
- ☐ CONKER
- ☐ COUNCIL
- ☐ CRAYON
- ☐ DRUM
- ☐ LAMPPOST
- ☐ LANE
- ☐ MEETING
- ☐ MOONLIGHT
- ☐ PAPER
- ☐ PARADE
- ☐ PAWPRINT
- ☐ PROCESSION
- ☐ RIBBON
- ☐ STRING
- ☐ TOFFEE
- ☐ TWILIGHT

The leftover letters spell

☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Case Notes

Copy your six clues from puzzles 55 to 60.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

Ruled out

- ☐ Arlo Finch _____
- ☐ Bess Tully _____
- ☐ Cyril Marsh _____
- ☐ Pickle _____

Who did it, and why?

_____

_____

_____

_____

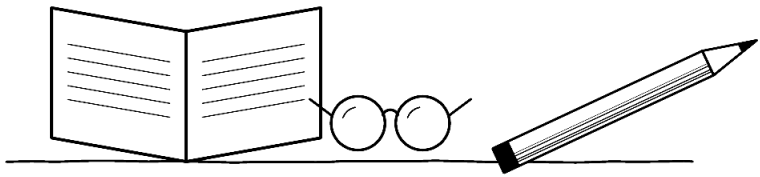
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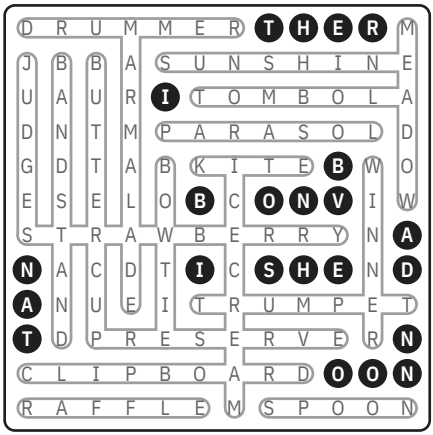
Check your answer with Hattie on page 116.

Solutions



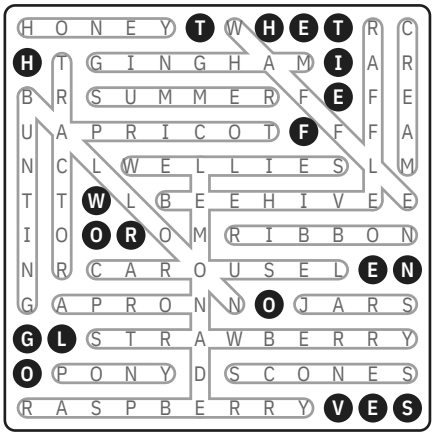
Every hidden word is looped in gray. The leftover letters are the white letters on black circles: read them left to right along each row, from the top row down, to spell the clue printed under each grid.

PUZZLE 1



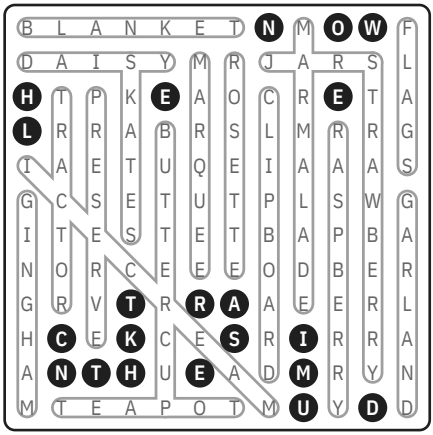
The ribbon vanished at noon

PUZZLE 2



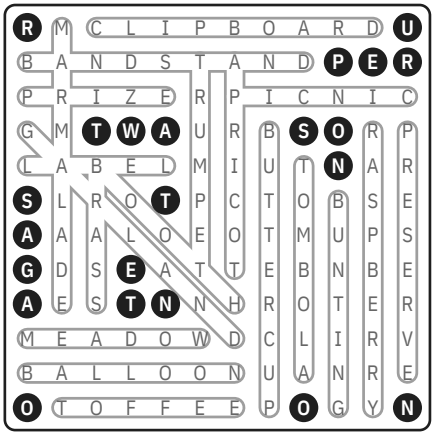
The thief wore no gloves

PUZZLE 3



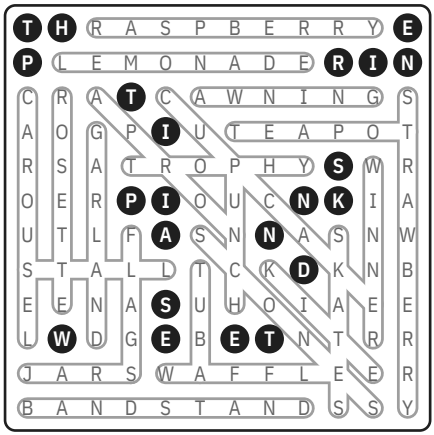
No wheel tracks in the mud

PUZZLE 4



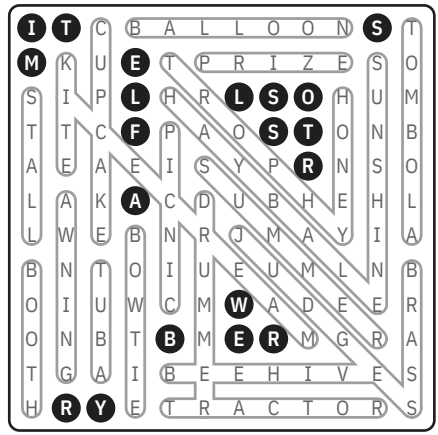
Rupert was on stage at noon

PUZZLE 5



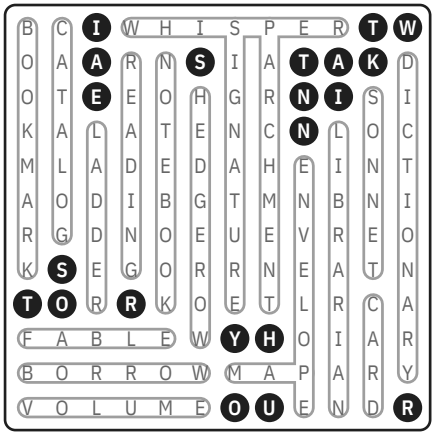
The print is pink and sweet

PUZZLE 6



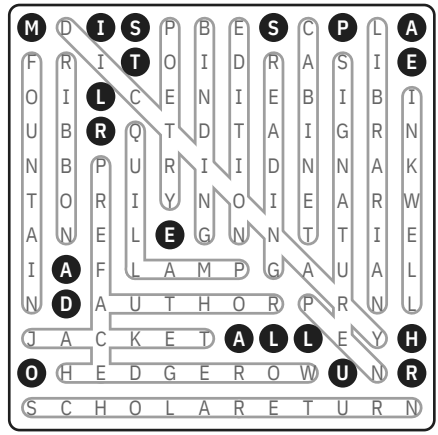
It smells of strawberry

PUZZLE 7



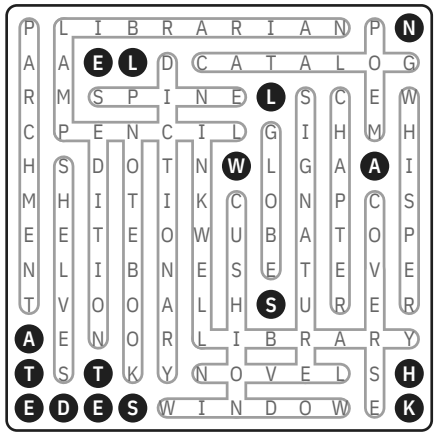
It was taken in story hour

PUZZLE 8



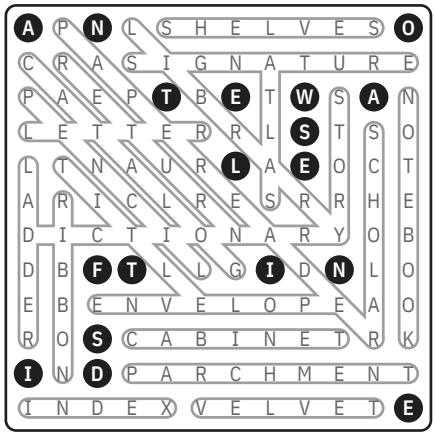
Miss patel read all hour

PUZZLE 9



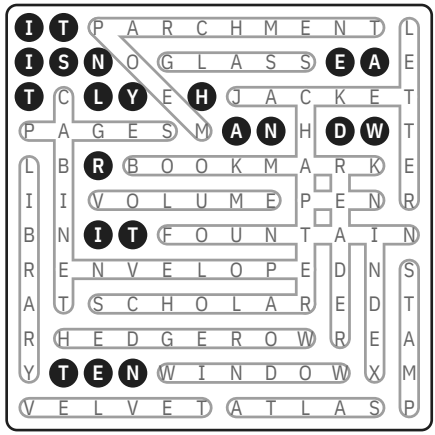
Nell was at the desk

PUZZLE 10



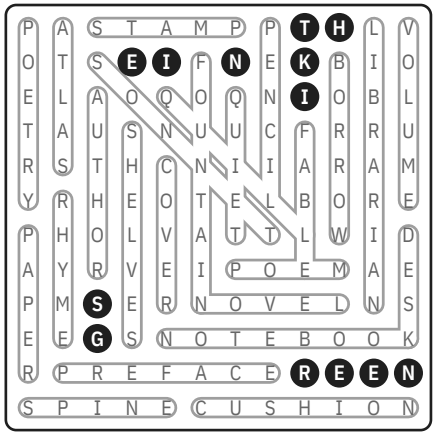
A note was left inside

PUZZLE 11



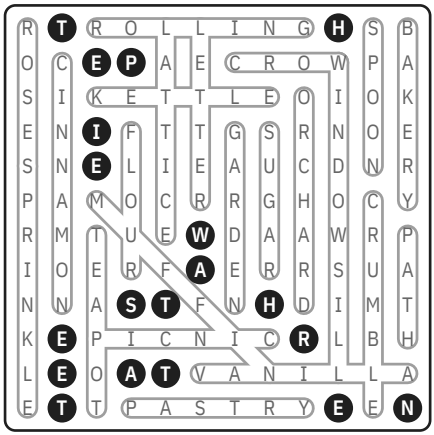
It is neatly handwritten

PUZZLE 12



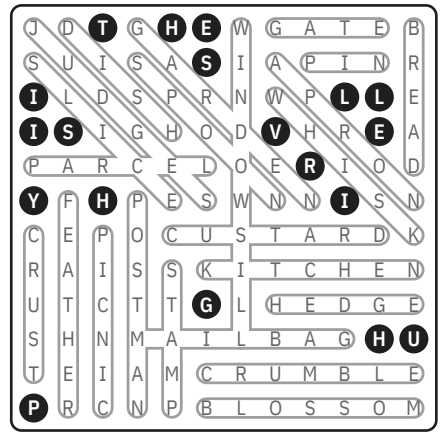
The ink is green

Puzzle 13



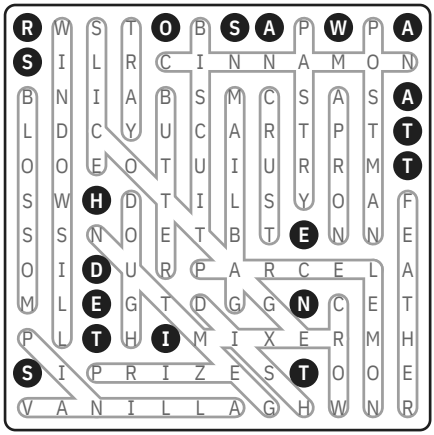
The pie was there at ten

Puzzle 14



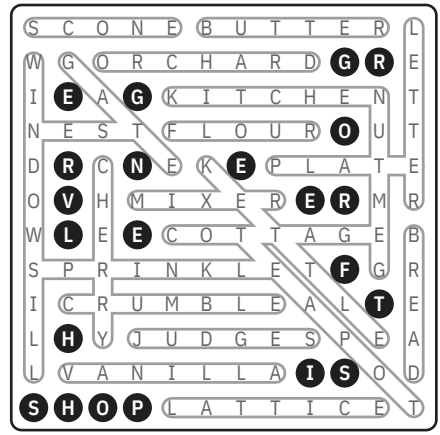
The sill is very high up

Puzzle 15



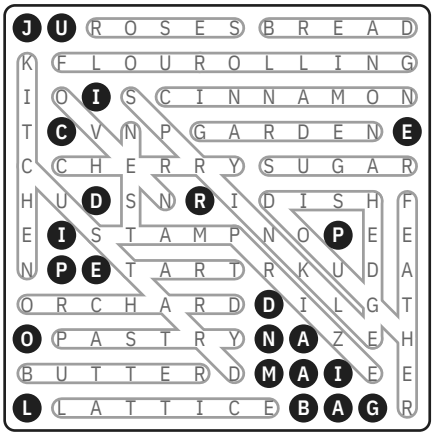
Rosa was at the dentist

Puzzle 16



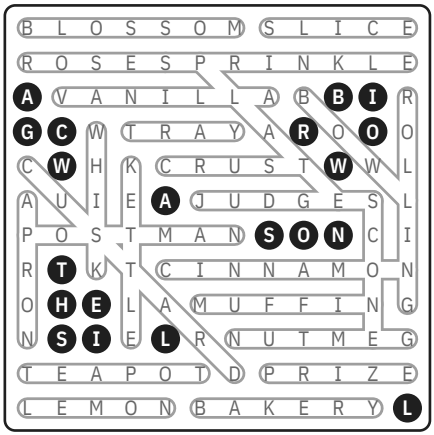
Gregor never left his shop

Puzzle 17



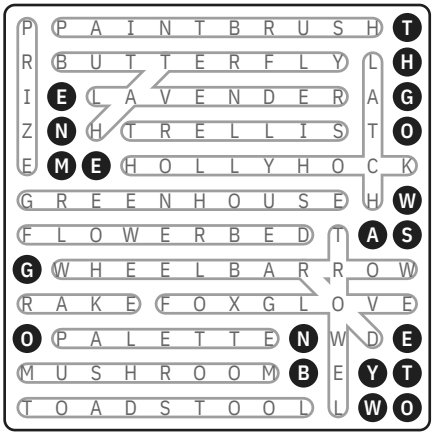
Juice dripped on a mailbag

Puzzle 18



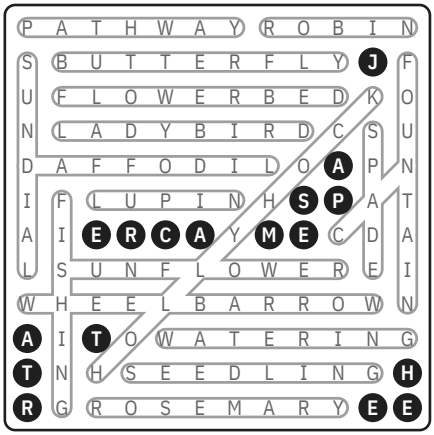
A big crow was on the sill

Puzzle 19



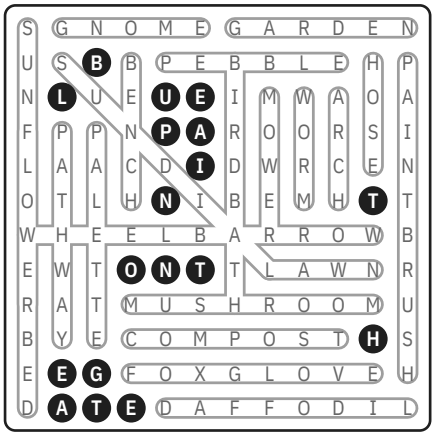
The gnome was gone by two

Puzzle 20



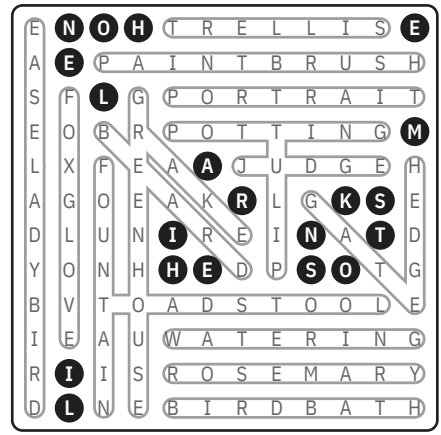
Jasper came at three

Puzzle 21



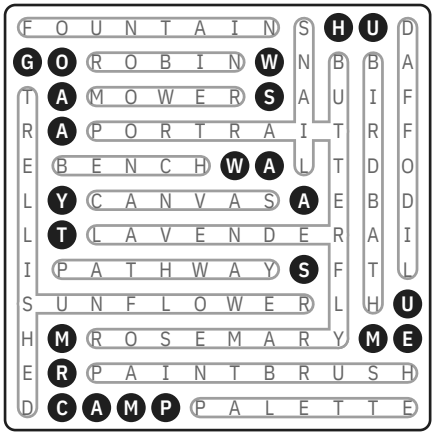
Blue paint on the gate

Puzzle 22



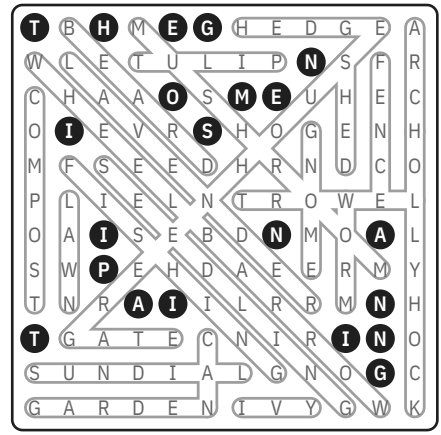
No heel marks in the soil

Puzzle 23



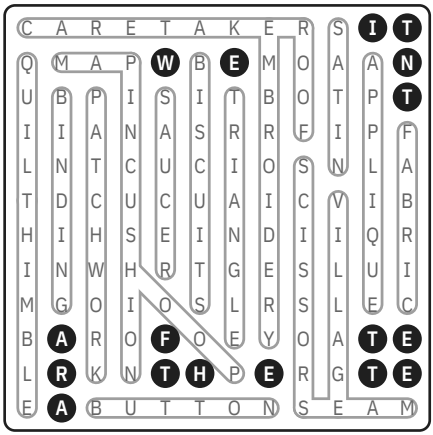
Hugo was away at summer camp

Puzzle 24



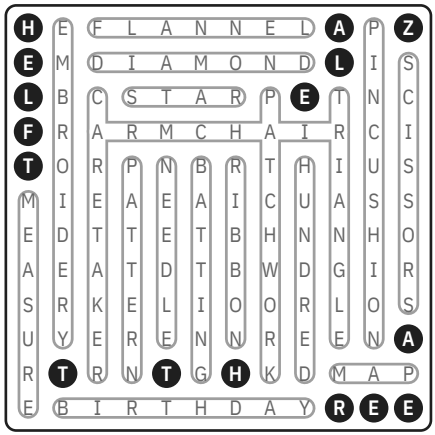
The gnome is in a painting

Puzzle 25



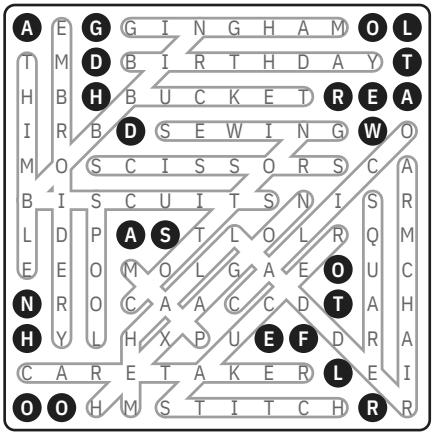
It went after the tea

Puzzle 26



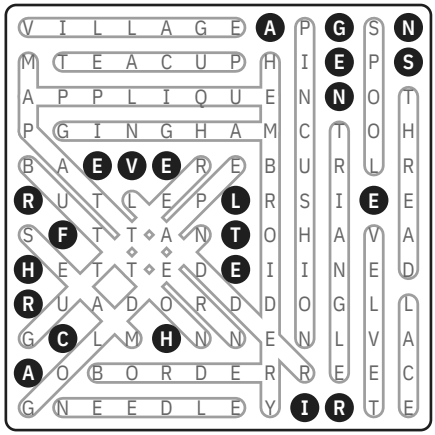
Hazel left at three

Puzzle 27



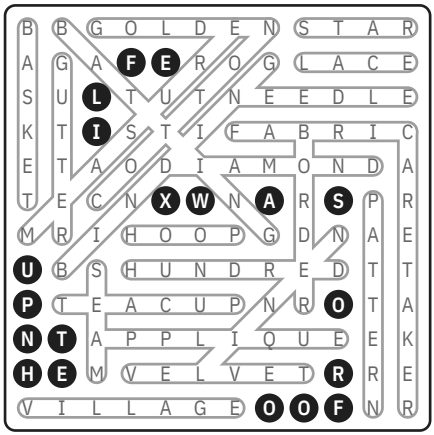
A gold thread was on the floor

Puzzle 28



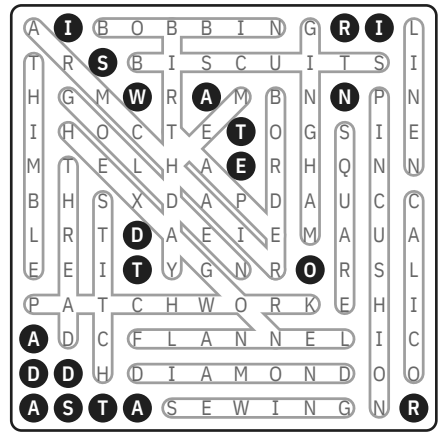
Agnes never left her chair

Puzzle 29



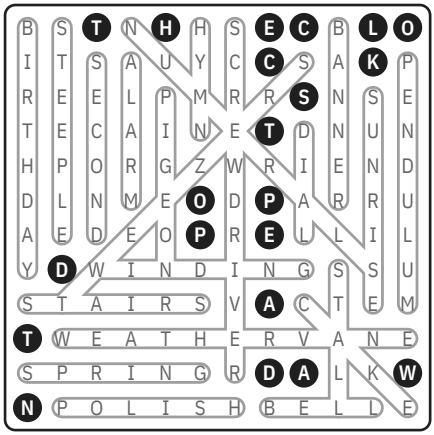
Felix was up on the roof

Puzzle 30



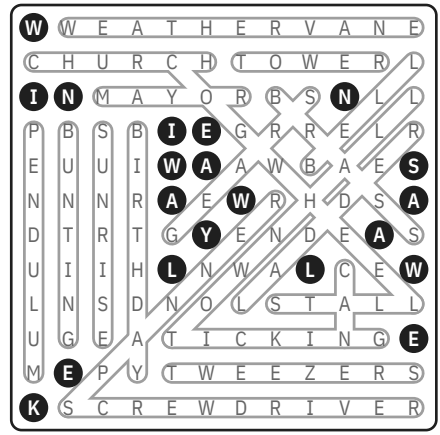
Iris wanted to add a star

Puzzle 31



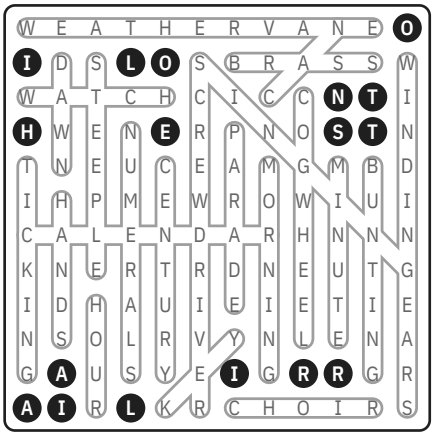
The clock stopped at dawn

Puzzle 32



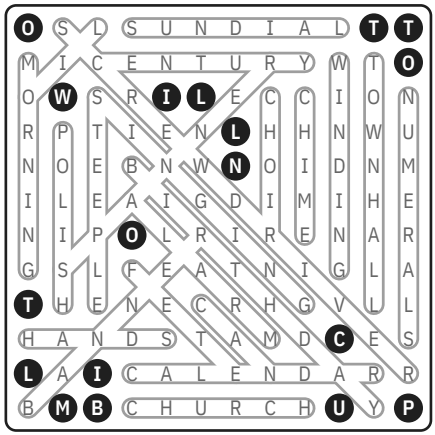
Winnie was away all week

Puzzle 33



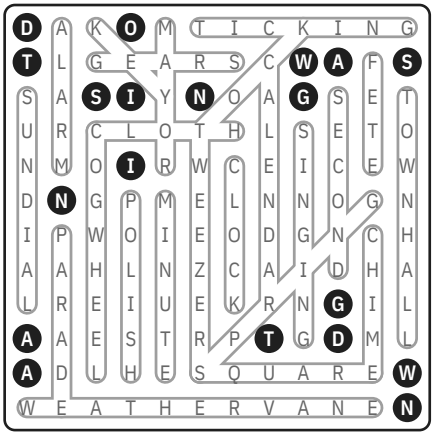
Oil on the stair rail

Puzzle 34



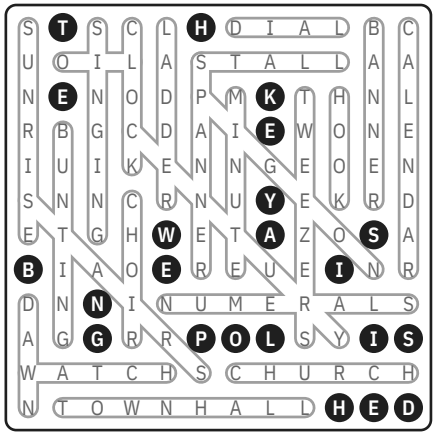
Otto will not climb up

Puzzle 35



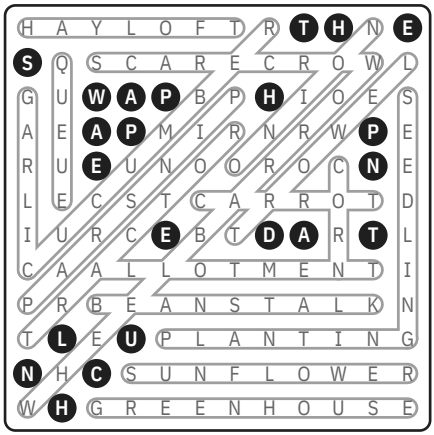
Dot was singing at dawn

Puzzle 36



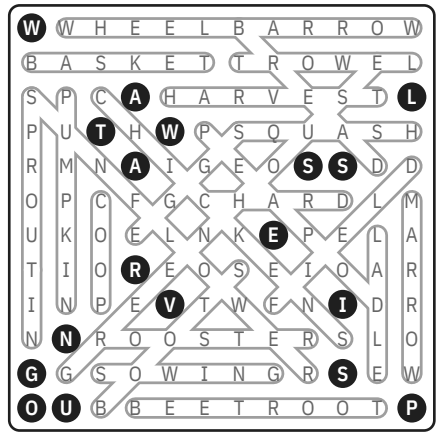
The key was being polished

PUZZLE 37



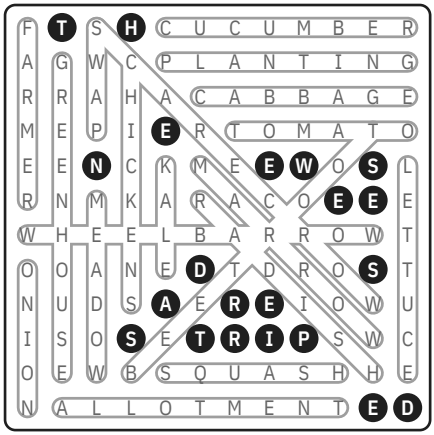
The swap happened at lunch

PUZZLE 38



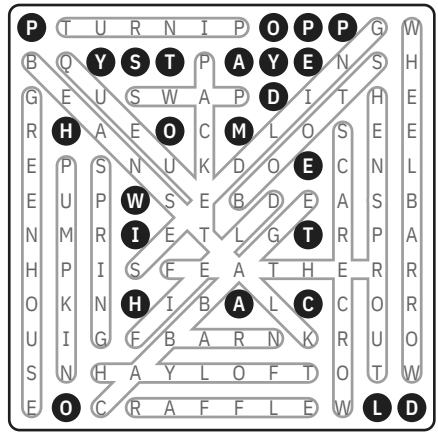
Walt was serving soup

PUZZLE 39



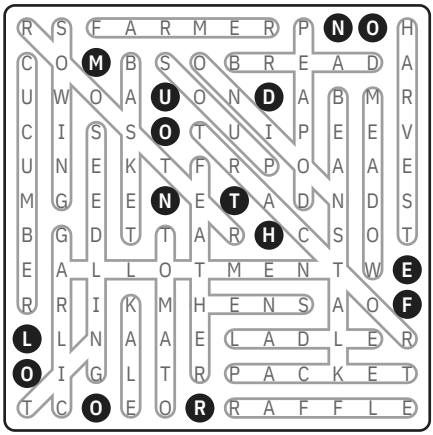
The new seeds are striped

PUZZLE 40



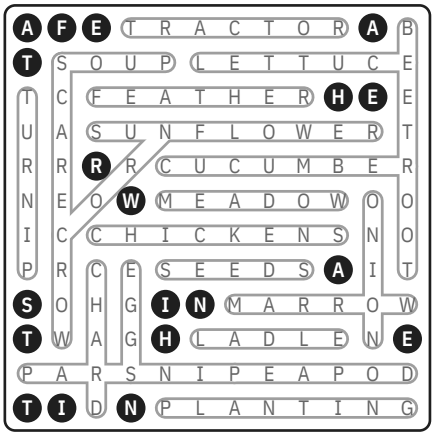
Poppy stayed home with a cold

PUZZLE 41



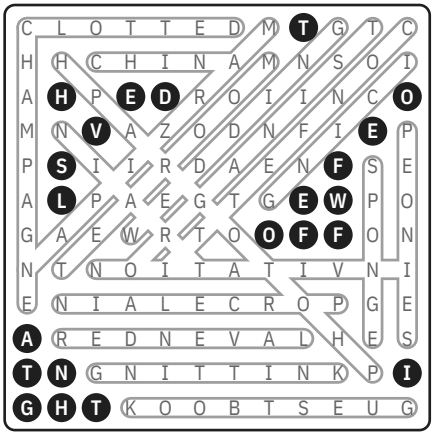
No mud on the floor

PUZZLE 42



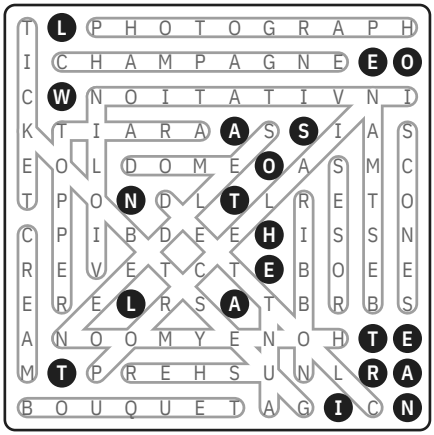
A feather was in the tin

PUZZLE 43



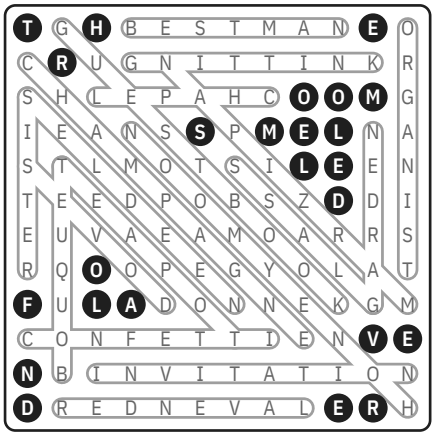
The doves flew off at night

PUZZLE 44



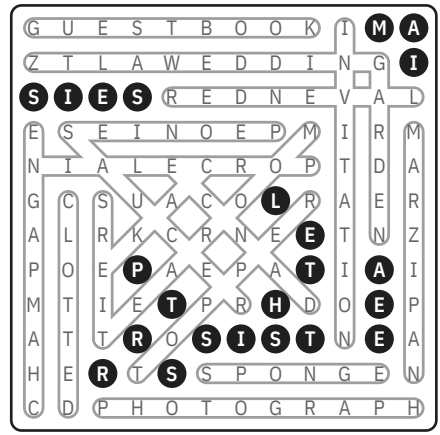
Leo was on the late train

PUZZLE 45



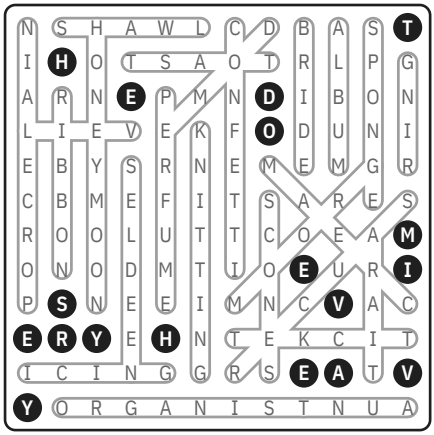
The room smelled of lavender

PUZZLE 46



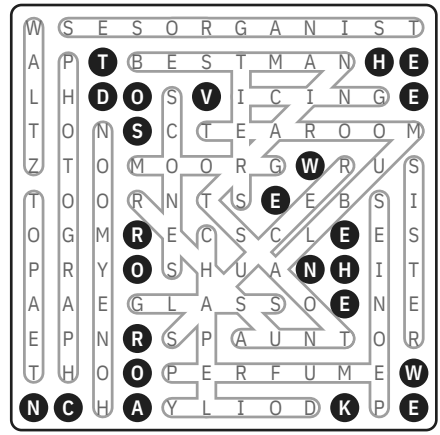
Maisie slept at her sisters

PUZZLE 47



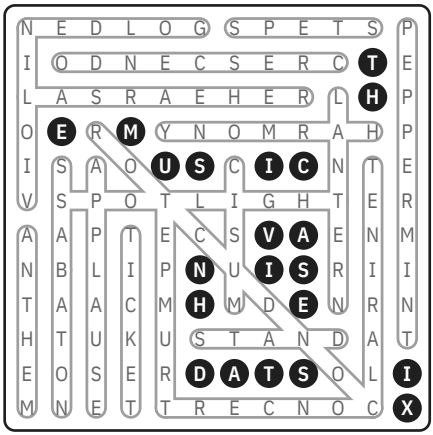
The dome is very heavy

PUZZLE 48



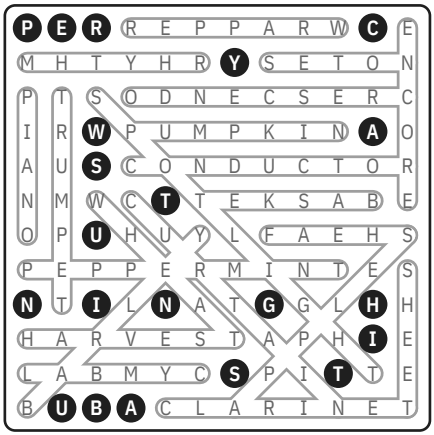
The doves were on her own cake

PUZZLE 49



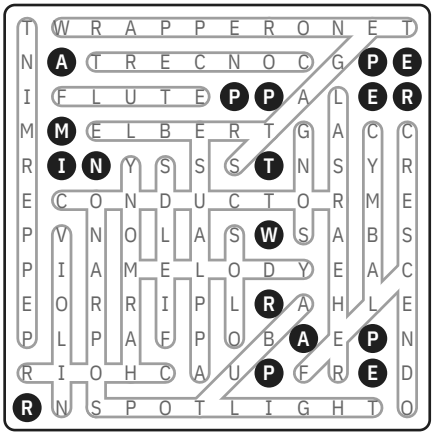
The music vanished at six

PUZZLE 50



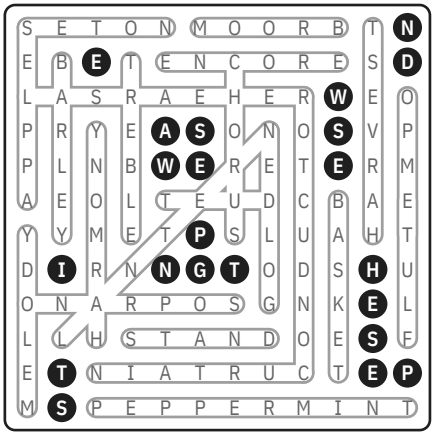
Percy was tuning his tuba

PUZZLE 51



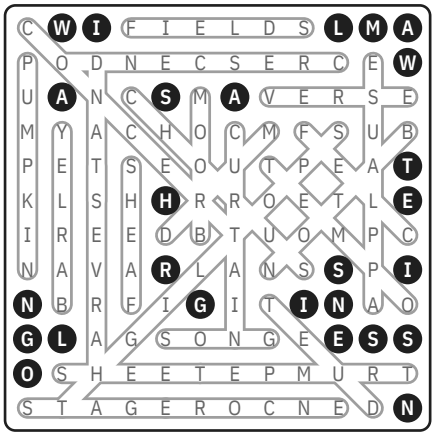
A peppermint wrapper

PUZZLE 52



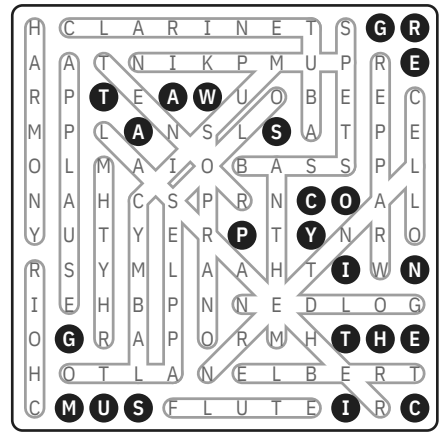
Ned was sweeping the steps

Puzzle 53



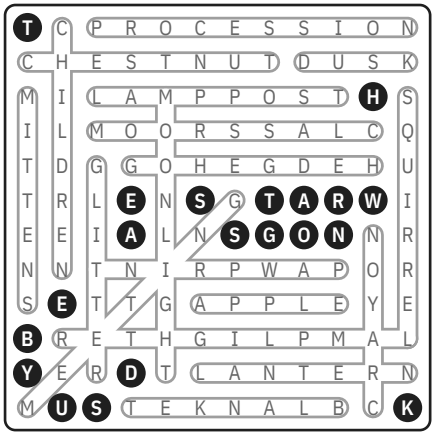
Wilma was at her singing lesson

Puzzle 54



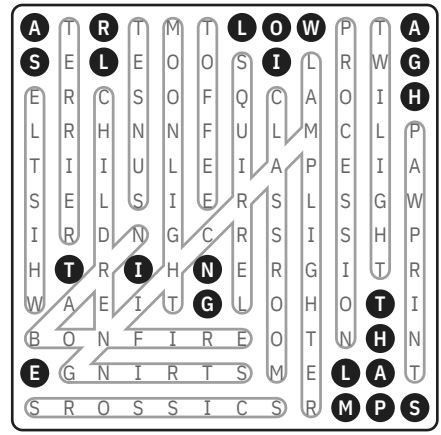
Greta was copying the music

Puzzle 55



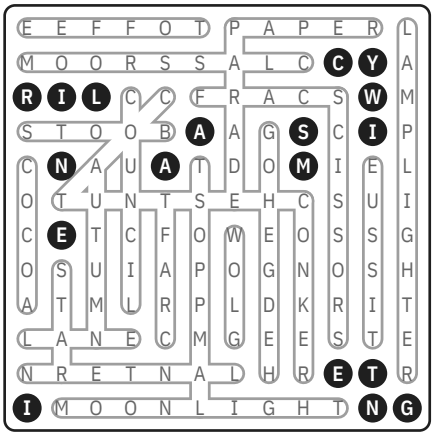
The star was gone by dusk

Puzzle 56



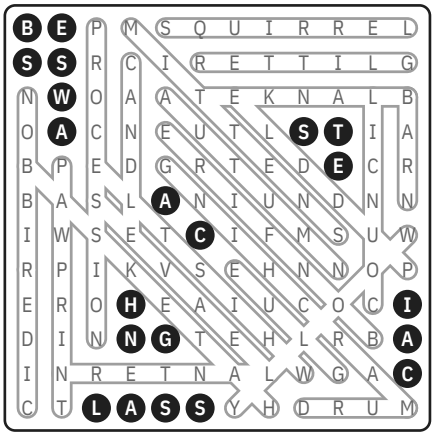
Arlo was lighting the lamps

Puzzle 57



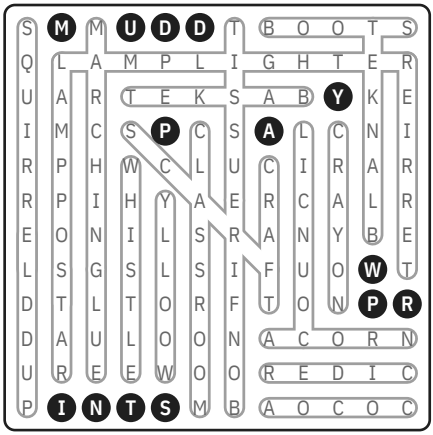
Cyril was in a meeting

Puzzle 58



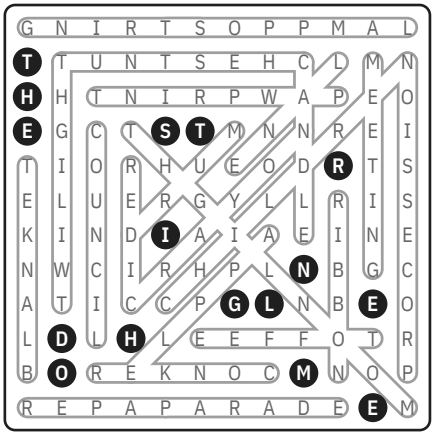
Bess was teaching a class

Puzzle 59



Muddy paw prints

Puzzle 60



The string led home

Case Answers

Case 1 The Blue Ribbon Jam

It was Della Pruitt.

The thief wore no gloves, so it was not Amos. There were no wheel tracks in the mud, so it was not Lottie on her skates. Rupert was on the stage at noon, in front of half the village. The thumbprint was pink and smelled of strawberry, just like Della's jam-stained fingers. Della owned up at once. She had noticed that the winning jar wore a label in her own handwriting. The labels had been swapped by mistake, and the winning jam was hers all along. She took the ribbon to prove it, then lost her nerve. The judges tasted again, agreed, and Della finally got her blue ribbon.

Case 2 The Missing First Edition

It was Professor Edmund Shaw.

The book went during story hour, and Miss Patel was reading to her class the whole time. Nell never left the front desk. The note was neatly handwritten, which Basil could not manage with his arm in a sling. The note was written in green ink, and only Professor Shaw writes in green. He had carried the book to the sunny window seat upstairs to compare the signature with an old letter in his bag. The letter was from the poet herself, to his great-grandmother, and the two were best friends. He brought the book back before closing, as promised, and gave the library the letter as a gift.

Case 3 The Cherry Pie on the Sill

It was Tom Fenn.

The sill was very high, too high for little Ollie. Rosa was at the dentist and Gregor never left his busy shop. That left Tom, the tall postman, and the cherry juice on his mailbag. Tom had seen a big crow pecking at the crust. He shooed it away, then tucked the pie safely into Bea's parcel box by the front door, where it dripped on his bag. He meant to tell her, but he was running late for his round. The pie was fine, apart from one small crow peck, and Bea won second prize. She gave Tom a slice.

Case 4 The Gnome Who Walked Away

It was Mabel Rook.

Jasper only arrived at three, after the gnome had gone. Clara's tall heels would have left marks in the soft soil, and there were none. Hugo was away at summer camp. The blue paint on the gate pointed to Mabel, and the picture on her easel proved it. Mabel had borrowed Sir Pumpernickel to paint his portrait as a surprise for Wendell's birthday. She carried him back at once, the judge gave Wendell's garden first prize, and the portrait now hangs over Wendell's fireplace.

Case 5 The Quilt Square

It was Iris Cole.

The square went after tea, and Hazel had left at three. Agnes never left her chair, and Felix was up on the roof fixing a gutter. The gold thread under the table belonged to Iris, and so did the sketch. Iris had slipped the square into her basket to stitch a little gold star on the map, marking the spot where the first quilting bee met a hundred years ago. She wanted it to be a surprise. Now everyone knows, and the star is the first thing people look for.

Case 6 The Clock That Stopped

It was Sam Ruddle.

Winnie was away all week. Otto will not climb the tower because he is afraid of heights. Dot was leading choir practice at dawn, when the clock stopped. The oil on the stair rail and the brass polish pointed to Sam. Sam had borrowed the key to polish it and oil the clock's gears for its hundredth birthday, as a surprise. He did not know the clock would stop if nobody wound it. He ran up with the key, wound the clock, and the mayor made him Assistant Clock Keeper on the spot.

Case 7 The Swapped Seeds

It was June Ashby.

The seeds were swapped at lunch, and Walt was serving soup. Poppy stayed home with a cold. Gil's muddy boots would have left mud on the clean floor. The striped sunflower seeds and the speckled feather led to June. It was an accident. While tidying the shelf, June had filled the wrong packet from her chicken-feed bag and tipped the Giant Moon seeds into the bag. Her hens had not eaten them yet, and every single pumpkin seed was found. The raffle went ahead, and June's hens got extra corn.

Case 8 The Doves on the Cake

It was Aunt Prudence.

The doves flew off at night. Leo was on the late train, and Maisie slept at her sister's. Kit could not have lifted the heavy dome with her bandaged wrist. The lavender smell and the old photograph pointed to Aunt Prudence, who had a spare key from the days when she ran the tea room herself. The doves had been on her own wedding cake fifty years before. She had taken them home to tie a tiny blue ribbon around each one, so Nora would have something old and something blue. Nora cried all over again, happily this time.

Case 9 The Harvest Song

It was Greta Holm.

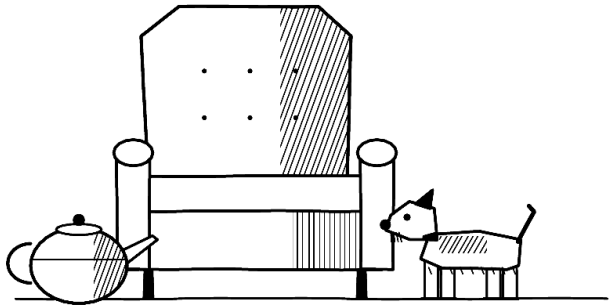
The music vanished at six. Percy was tuning his tuba in the shed, Ned was sweeping the steps in front of everyone, and Wilma was at her singing lesson. The peppermint wrapper and the big dark notes led to Greta. The director's handwriting was tiny, and Greta could not read it from the piano stool. She took the song home to copy it out in large notes she could see. She brought both copies back that night, and Golden Fields was the hit of the concert.

Case 10 The Lantern Parade Star

It was Pickle.

The star was gone by dusk. Arlo was lighting the lamps, Cyril was stuck in his meeting and Bess was teaching her class. The muddy paw prints and the chewed string led all the way to Hattie's own house, where Pickle was asleep in his basket, curled around the paper star. Its rustling had been too much for him to resist. The star was a little crumpled but not torn, and Bess patched it with glitter in ten minutes. Pickle walked at the front of the parade, right under the star, looking very pleased with himself.

Thank You for Visiting



Hattie and Pickle hope you enjoyed your time in Thimble Hill, and that the kettle stayed warm while you searched.

If you liked this book, a short review on Amazon helps other puzzlers find it, and it means a great deal to a small, independent author.

Blake La Pierre